STARTUP EXECUTION PLAN | INVESTMENT PROPOSAL | IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

SmartBiz AI

Complete Startup Execution Plan, Investment Proposal, and Implementation Roadmap

A proposed business management tool for small online sellers and home-based businesses in Karachi, Pakistan

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Prepared for: the founding group of entrepreneurs, university project reviewers, and prospective advisors

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Important. SmartBiz AI is a proposed startup. No product, customers, revenue, partnerships, investors, or legal approvals exist yet. All forecasts are planning scenarios, not guaranteed outcomes. Legal and tax content is general information and must be confirmed by qualified Pakistani professionals.

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Document Purpose, Scope and Reading Guide

This document is an execution plan for SmartBiz AI, a proposed software startup for small online sellers and home-based businesses in Karachi, Pakistan. It is written so that a group of entrepreneurs can decide whether to proceed, what to do first, who does what, how much it may cost, and how to judge progress. It can be used as a university project submission and as a starting point for investor or advisor discussions.

> **Status of SmartBiz AI.** SmartBiz AI is a proposal. No product has been built, launched, or connected to any external service. There are no customers, revenues, partnerships, investor commitments, or legal approvals. Everything described as a feature, price, target, or forecast is a plan or an assumption to be tested.

Scope

- **Covered:** market and problem analysis, product scope, competitors, business model, go-to-market, team, legal and risk plan, timeline, financial plan, KPIs, and immediate next actions (12 steps).
- **Not covered:** detailed software design documents, final legal advice, tax advice, or audited financial statements. These need qualified professionals (see Step 8).
- **Geography and currency:** Karachi first. All financial figures are in Pakistani rupees (PKR). US dollar amounts are shown only where the source prices in dollars, using an assumed rate of PKR 278 per US$1 [A].

How to read the evidence labels

Every market figure and financial estimate carries one of four labels, so the reader can see how much trust to place in it:

Table 1. *Evidence labels used throughout*

Label	Meaning	Example in this document
[V]	Verified figure with a source (listed in the References).	SMEDA estimate of 5.2 million SMEs in Pakistan.
[C]	Calculation based on sourced data, with the formula shown.	Estimated SMEs in Karachi = 5.2 million x 18% x 36.6%.
[A]	Illustrative assumption chosen by the authors. It must be tested.	Monthly customer churn of 6%.
[Q]	Quotation required before any money is committed.	Company registration agent fees; AI API running cost.

Startup Vision, Mission and Objectives

Table 2. *Vision, mission and objectives*

Element	Statement
Vision	Every small online seller in Pakistan can run orders, stock, and money from one simple, affordable tool, in a language they are comfortable with.
Mission	Replace scattered chats and spreadsheets with a simple order, customer, and inventory system priced in PKR, then add AI help that saves sellers time.
90-day objective	Within 90 days of Day 1: finish customer validation (target 30 interviews), finish product design, and have an alpha version of the core MVP running with 5-10 pilot users [A].
12-month objective	Within 12 months: public launch in Karachi, first paying customers from month 5, and about 129 paying customers by month 12 under the Standard plan forecast [A].
Long-term direction	Add AI assistance (Phase 2) and carefully selected integrations (Phase 3) only after the core product proves it keeps customers.

Assumptions and Research Limitations

- **No reliable count of online sellers.** No source reviewed gives a verified number of online sellers in Pakistan or Karachi. The market sizing in Step 2 therefore uses a transparent, labelled estimation method instead of a quoted statistic.
- **Published e-commerce estimates disagree.** 2025 market-size figures range from US$4.74 billion to US$10.42 billion depending on the publisher (Figure 2). They measure different things, so none is used as a revenue forecast for SmartBiz AI.
- **Competitor information comes from public web pages** viewed in October 2026. Prices change, and some pages are marketing material. Competitor features not stated on a page are marked "not stated", not "absent".
- **Costs are benchmarks, not quotations.** Salary figures come from job-site averages for Pakistan and Karachi. They vary widely and must be confirmed with real offers.
- **Forecasts are not guarantees.** The financial model uses assumptions for customer growth, churn, and costs. The results are planning scenarios, not predictions of profit.
- **Legal and tax content is general information.** A Pakistani lawyer and a tax adviser must confirm every point before action.
- **Personas are fictional composites** created to organise hypotheses. Interviews in Phase 1 should replace them with real findings.

Step 1: Executive Summary

Table 3. *Executive summary at a glance*

Item	Summary
Business concept	SmartBiz AI is a proposed cloud-based business management tool for small online sellers: one place for orders, customers, stock, expenses, and simple reports.
Problem (to be validated)	Orders arrive through WhatsApp, Instagram, and Facebook and are tracked in chats or spreadsheets. Possible results: missed messages, unclear order status, overselling, and no clear view of profit.
Proposed solution	MVP: login and dashboard, order and customer records, product and inventory management, order-status tracking, sales summaries, expense tracking with estimated profit, low-stock alerts, PKR support. Later: AI help (Phase 2) and integrations (Phase 3).
Target customers	Home-based and small online sellers in Karachi with roughly 15-500 orders a month, selling mainly through WhatsApp, Instagram, and Facebook.
Value proposition	A simple, PKR-priced tool that takes minutes to start using and shows what is pending, what is in stock, and roughly what was earned.
Revenue model	Monthly and annual subscriptions: Free (limited), Starter PKR 1,499, Growth PKR 2,999, Business PKR 5,999 per month (ex-tax) [A]. Planned blended revenue per paying customer: PKR 2,549 per month [C].
Competitive position	Competitors include spreadsheets and manual WhatsApp use, global tools priced in US dollars, and local POS or inventory products. SmartBiz AI aims at the gap between them. This is a hypothesis to test, not an established advantage.
90-day objective	Validate the problem with about 30 interviews, finish design, and run an alpha of the core MVP with 5-10 pilot users [A].
12-month objective	Launch publicly in Karachi in month 5; reach about 129 paying customers by month 12 (Standard plan forecast, PKR 329,194 monthly revenue) [A].
Proposed team	Minimum for the MVP: two founders (CEO/product and technical lead) plus a developer and outsourced accounting, design, and legal review. Further hires only when revenue supports them.
Funding requirement	Three scenarios: Lean PKR 1.05 million, Standard PKR 3.45 million, Growth PKR 13.70 million, each including a 15% contingency [A] [Q]. Recommended starting point: Lean-to-Standard, released in stages after validation gates.
Key milestones	Week 4: validation gate. Week 6: design freeze. Week 13 (about day 90): alpha. Week 18: pilot exit and launch decision. Month 5: first paid customers. Month 7: AI beta. Month 12: review.

No promises. This plan does not promise profitability or any number of customers. The Standard plan forecast shows a monthly operating loss at month 12 and reaches break-even at roughly 142 paying customers, which the forecast reaches only after the first year. If the validation gates in Step 2 fail, the recommended action is to narrow the segment, change the product, or stop, and to spend little before that point.

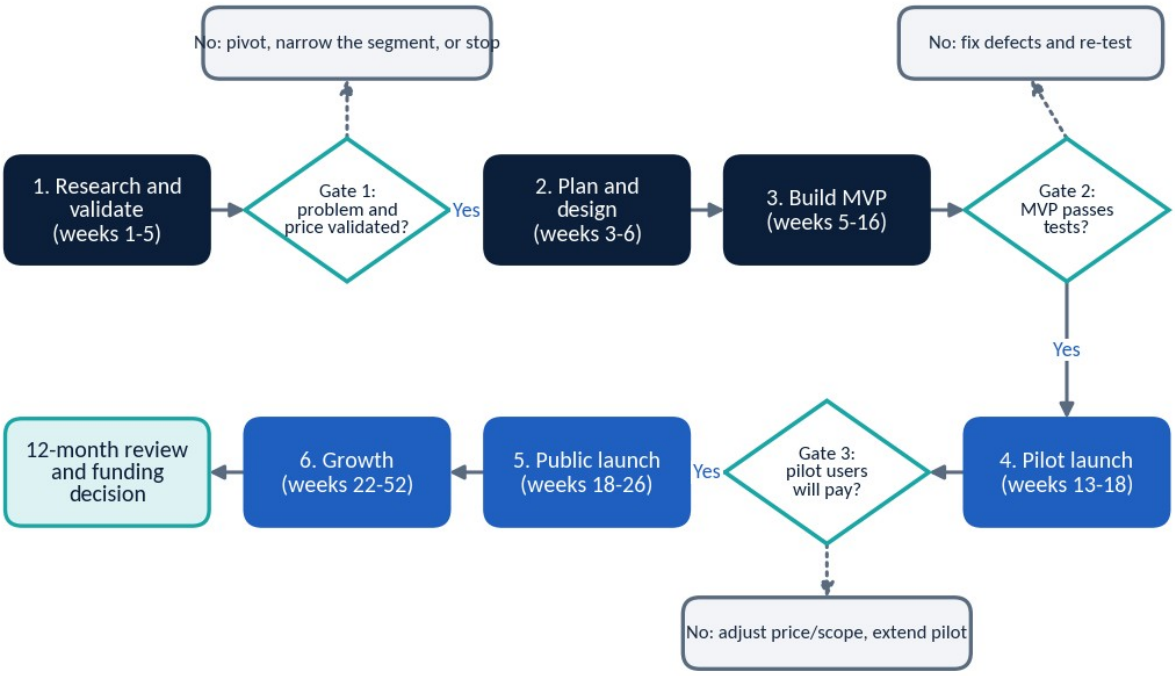


Figure 1. *End-to-end business implementation flow with investment gates*

Step 2: Problem and Market Analysis

2.1 Market overview

Online selling in Pakistan is growing, and a large part of it runs through social media and chat apps rather than through dedicated online stores. The figures below describe the environment. They are not forecasts for SmartBiz AI.

- **Connectivity.** DataReportal reports about 117 million internet users in Pakistan in October 2025 [V]. It reported about 66.9 million social media user identities in January 2025 [V]. User identities may not be unique people.
- **E-commerce size estimates differ widely.** Statista, quoted by DHL, projects US$4.74 billion for 2025 [V]. ECDB estimates US$5.78 billion in 2025 revenue with 10-15% growth [V]. A payments-company blog cites the Asian Development Bank at US$10.42 billion for 2025 [V] (secondary source; low confidence). Definitions differ, so the gap is expected.
- **Cash dominates.** In a SMEDA-ADBI survey, 72.29% of Pakistani SMEs reported cash as their main payment method [V]. Cash on delivery (COD) is common in online selling, which is why payment and COD tracking matter to sellers.
- **Small businesses are numerous and mostly informal.** SMEDA and others estimate about 5.2 million SMEs, with Sindh holding about 17-18% [V]. About 70% are estimated to operate in the informal sector, and 98% report annual turnover below PKR 150 million [V].
- **Karachi is large.** The 2023 census counted about 20.38 million people in Karachi Division and 55.70 million in Sindh [V].

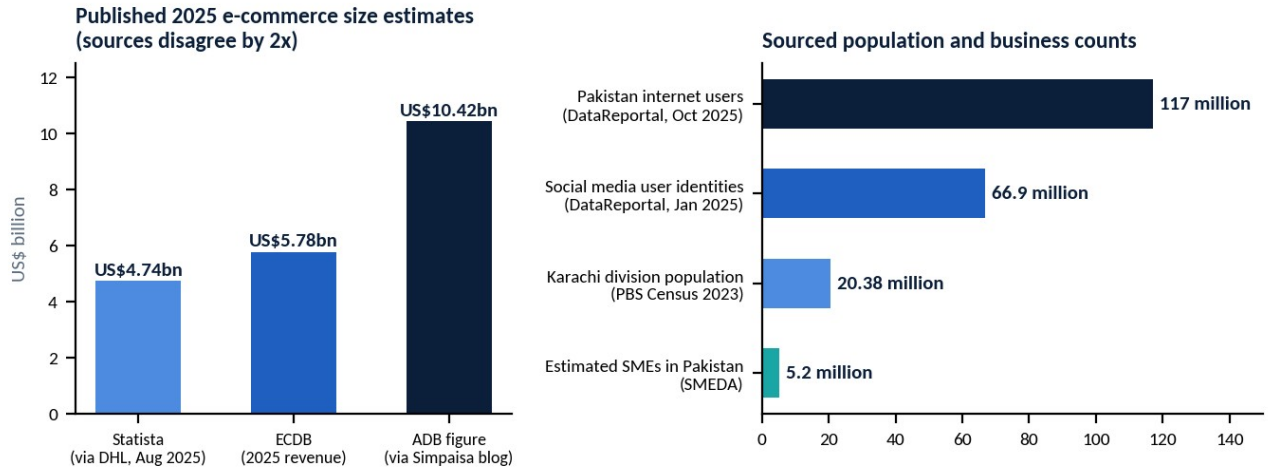


Figure 2. *Published e-commerce size estimates (left) and sourced counts (right). Sources: DHL/Statista, ECDB, Simpaisa blog citing ADB, DataReportal, PBS census, SMEDA.*

2.2 Needs of small online sellers in Karachi (hypotheses to validate)

The problems below come from the project brief and general observation of social commerce. They are hypotheses. Phase 1 interviews decide which are real, how severe they are, and whether sellers will pay to solve them.

Table 4. *Customer pain points, hypothesised severity and evidence needed*

Pain point	What the seller may experience	Hypothesised severity	Evidence to collect
Orders scattered across channels	Orders in WhatsApp, Instagram DMs, Facebook, notebooks, spreadsheets.	High	Count of channels used; time spent searching for an order.

Pain point	What the seller may experience	Hypothesised severity	Evidence to collect
Missed or late replies	Messages buried; customers lost while the seller is busy.	High	Self-reported lost sales; reply time.
Unclear order status	Pending, confirmed, cancelled, delivered kept in memory.	High	Disputes or confusion per month.
Stock confusion and overselling	Selling items that are out of stock; no low-stock warning.	Medium-High	Overselling incidents per month.
No customer records	No history of who bought what; no follow-up.	Medium	Share of repeat customers; use of notes.
No view of profit	Sales known roughly; expenses and profit unclear.	Medium-High	Do they know last month's profit? How?
Affordable software is hard to find	Global tools priced in US dollars; local tools built for shops (POS).	Medium	Tools tried and why abandoned; spend on software.

2.3 Existing ways sellers solve these problems

- **WhatsApp Business app, chats and labels** (free). Familiar, but not a database.
- **Spreadsheets and notebooks** (free). Flexible, but error-prone and hard to use on a phone during a busy day.
- **Local POS and inventory software** such as Hulm POS, Granet Pro, ManageKaro, and Smart Stock. Built mainly for shops with counter billing [V] (Step 4).
- **Global inventory tools** such as Zoho Inventory. Priced in US dollars, with English-first support [V].
- **Marketplace seller tools** such as Daraz Seller Center for sellers on that marketplace. These do not cover orders from WhatsApp or Instagram. This route was not researched in detail.

2.4 Target customer segments and personas

Table 5. *Target segments. Order ranges are assumptions for planning only*

Segment	Typical seller	Orders / month [A]	Main channel	Likely need
A. Micro home-based seller	Home bakery, handmade items, tailoring, resellers. Usually one person with family help.	15-60	WhatsApp, Instagram DMs	Simple order list, status, reminders.
B. Growing social seller	Clothing, shoes, accessories, gifts. May have one helper or packer.	60-250	Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp	Stock control, COD tracking, customer history.
C. Established small online business	Cosmetics, electronics, fashion with 2-5 staff.	250-600	Facebook page, website, WhatsApp	Reports, expenses, profit view, team use.

Table 6. *Fictional composite personas (hypotheses to be replaced by interview findings)*

	Persona 1: Ayesha	Persona 2: Bilal	Persona 3: Sana
Business	Home bakery and gift boxes, Gulshan-e-Iqbal	Streetwear reseller, North Nazimabad	Skincare and cosmetics seller, DHA
Team and volume	1 person; about 30 orders a month	1 owner + 1 packer; about 150 orders	3 staff; about 400 orders
How she/he works now	WhatsApp chats and a notebook	Instagram DMs, Facebook page, spreadsheet	WhatsApp Business, several spreadsheets
Main frustration	Forgets who asked for what; late replies	Sells items already sold; COD confusion	Does not know real profit; weak follow-up
Might pay for	Free or PKR 1,499 plan	PKR 2,999 plan	PKR 5,999 plan

2.5 Customer buying behaviour and willingness to pay

There is no verified data in this document on what Karachi sellers will pay for such software. The pricing in Step 5 is built from competitor prices and must be tested in interviews and in the pilot. Early signals to look for:

- Sellers already paying for any tool (software, ads, courier apps) and how much.
- Whether the buyer is the owner or a family member, and whether payment is by mobile wallet, bank transfer, or card.
- Reaction to three price points (PKR 1,499 / 2,999 / 5,999 per month) shown in a simple price-reaction question.
- Sensitivity to US-dollar pricing, because exchange-rate changes can alter the local cost of imported tools.

2.6 Market opportunity: TAM, SAM and SOM

TAM = Total Addressable Market: everyone who could in theory use the product (the whole market). SAM = Serviceable Available Market: the part of the TAM the business can actually serve with its product, language, and location. SOM = Serviceable Obtainable Market: the part of the SAM the business can realistically win in the near term.

Because no verified count of online sellers exists, the estimate below starts from sourced SME numbers and applies labelled assumptions. It is an illustrative scenario, not market data.

Table 7. *Transparent calculation inputs for market sizing*

Step	Calculation	Result	Basis
1. SMEs in Pakistan	SMEDA estimate	5,200,000	[V]
2. Sindh share of SMEs	5,200,000 x 18% (SMEDA-ADBI: 18.05%)	936,000	[C]
3. Karachi share of Sindh	Karachi Division 20.38m / Sindh 55.70m = 36.6% of population	36.6%	[C]
4. SMEs in Karachi	936,000 x 36.6% (assumes SMEs follow population; probably understates Karachi)	about 342,000	[C] [A]
5. Share selling online	Assumed 5% of SMEs sell through social media or online channels	5%	[A]
6. National online-selling SMEs	5,200,000 x 5%	260,000	[C] [A]
7. Karachi online sellers	342,000 x 5%	about 17,100	[C] [A]
8. Fit with target segment	Assumed 40% are small social-commerce sellers with 15+ orders a month, using phone and chat apps	40%	[A]
9. Revenue per customer	Blended average PKR 2,549 per month x 12	PKR 30,588 per year	[C] [A]

Table 8. *TAM, SAM and SOM (illustrative scenario; every figure depends on the assumptions above)*

Measure	Customers	Annual revenue potential	Formula
TAM (national)	260,000	about PKR 7.95 billion	260,000 x PKR 30,588
SAM (Karachi, target segment)	6,840	about PKR 209 million	17,100 x 40% = 6,840; x PKR 30,588
SOM (12 months, Standard plan)	about 129	about PKR 4.0 million run-rate	forecast customers at month 12 x PKR 30,588
SOM (24 months, illustrative)	about 504	about PKR 15.4 million run-rate	Standard plan extension (Step 10)

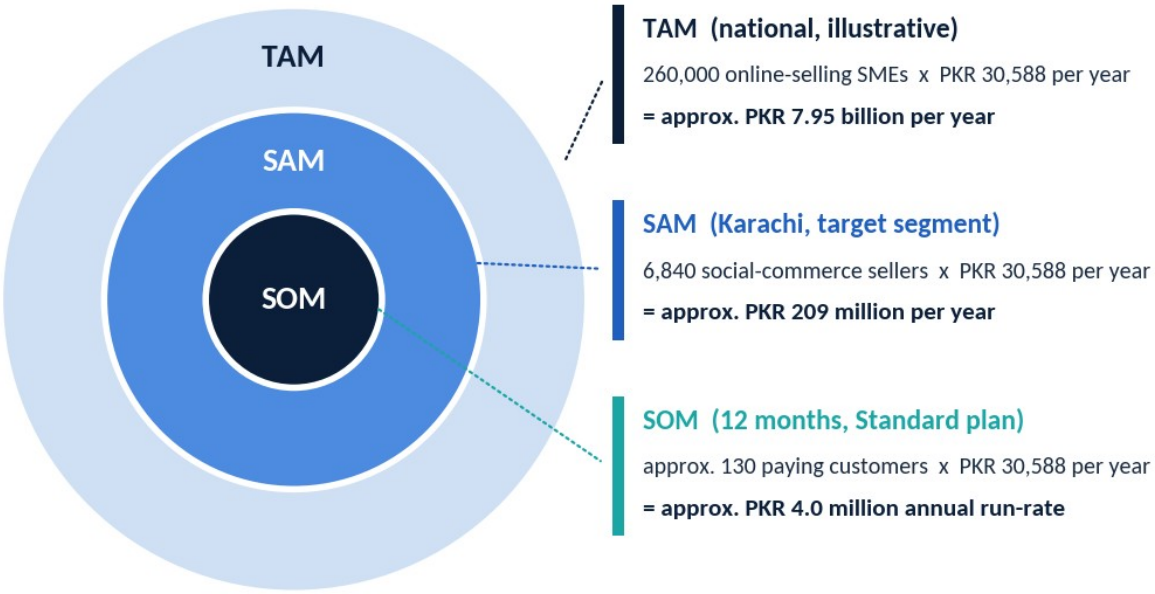


Figure 3. *TAM, SAM and SOM diagram (illustrative scenario)*

Reading the result. The 12-month SOM of about 129 customers is about 1.9% of the SAM. If the real SAM is half the estimate, the same customer target becomes about 3.8% of it. Sensitivity matters: changing the online-seller share from 5% to 3% cuts the SAM by 40%.

2.7 Proposed customer interview questionnaire

Interview at least 30 sellers across the three segments, 20-30 minutes each, in Urdu or English. Do not pitch. Ask about past behaviour, not future intentions. Offer a small thank-you (for example, a mobile top-up) [A].

1. Tell me about your business: what you sell, how long, how many people help you.
2. Where do customers contact you? Roughly how many orders do you get in a typical week?
3. Walk me through the last order you received, from the first message to delivery.
4. Where do you write down orders and customer details today?
5. How do you know what stock is left? Have you ever sold something you did not have? What happened?
6. How do you track pending, confirmed, cancelled, and delivered orders?
7. How many customer messages went unanswered or answered late last week? What did that cost you?
8. How do you handle cash on delivery and returns?
9. How do you work out your expenses and profit? When did you last check?
10. What tools or apps have you tried for your business? What did you like or dislike? Why did you stop?
11. What do you spend each month on tools, ads, or software?
12. Who would use such a tool: you, family, staff?
13. What phone or computer do you use for business? How comfortable are you with apps and spreadsheets?
14. Which language do you prefer for an app and for customer messages: Urdu, Roman Urdu, English?
15. If a tool solved your biggest problem, how would you want to pay (monthly, yearly, mobile wallet, bank transfer, card)?
16. At what monthly price would this be too cheap to trust? A bargain? Getting expensive? Too expensive?
17. Would you test an early version for four weeks and share feedback? Can I contact you again?
18. Whom else should I talk to?

2.8 Competitor and market research methodology

1. **List** direct competitors (order and inventory tools), indirect competitors (CRM, POS, storefront builders), and substitutes (spreadsheets, WhatsApp Business app).
2. **Record** from official websites and pricing pages: price, currency, billing period, limits, features, languages, integrations. Save a dated screenshot of each page.
3. **Test** the free plans or trials as a new seller. Time how long it takes to record the first order.
4. **Ask** for quotes on WhatsApp or by email where prices are not published.
5. **Read** public reviews and app-store comments for recurring complaints.
6. **Score** each competitor on the same criteria (Step 4) and update the table every quarter.

2.9 Market validation plan

Table 9. *Validation plan with proposed success criteria*

Hypothesis	Test	Success criterion (proposed)	Week
Sellers lose time or sales because orders and stock are scattered.	30 interviews; severity ranking.	At least 20 of 30 rate order tracking or stock as a top-3 problem.	1-4
Current tools are not satisfying.	Interview question 10; competitor trials.	At least 15 of 30 have tried and dropped a tool, or still use spreadsheets or chats only.	1-4
Sellers will try a new tool.	Click-through prototype demo; sign-up list.	At least 10 sellers commit to be pilot users.	3-6
Price between PKR 1,499 and 5,999 is acceptable.	Price-reaction question; pilot offer.	At least 8 of 30 accept a price at or above PKR 1,499 as fair.	3-5
Setup is simple enough.	Alpha: time to first recorded order.	At least 7 of 10 pilot users record 5 orders within 14 days.	13-16

Step 3: Solution and Product Scope

3.1 Product vision, mission and value proposition

Table 10. *Product vision, mission and value proposition*

Product vision	One simple screen where a small seller sees every order, who it is for, what is in stock, and roughly what was earned.
Product mission	Make the first order entry take under a minute and the first useful report appear within a week.
Main value proposition	Less chaos, fewer missed orders, fewer overselling mistakes, and a clearer view of profit, at a price a small seller can afford. These benefits are hypotheses until pilot users confirm them.

3.2 Core features, MVP scope and exclusions

Table 11. *MVP scope and exclusions*

Module	MVP features (planned)	Not in the MVP
Account and dashboard	User login; dashboard with today's orders, pending orders, low-stock items.	Multiple user roles and permissions; social login.
Orders	Add, edit, view, delete orders; order status (pending, confirmed, shipped, delivered, cancelled).	Automatic capture of orders from WhatsApp or Instagram.
Customers	Customer records, contact details, order history.	Customer messaging inside the app.
Products and stock	Product list, prices, stock quantity, automatic stock reduction, low-stock alerts.	Barcode scanning, multi-warehouse.
Money	Expense tracking; estimated profit = sales minus product cost minus expenses; PKR formatting.	Tax invoicing, accounting ledger, payment gateway.
Reports	Sales summaries by day, week, month; top products; expense summary; export to CSV.	Advanced analytics and forecasting.

Excluded from the MVP: WhatsApp Business API, courier integrations, payment and COD reconciliation, AI features, native mobile apps, point-of-sale features, marketplace synchronisation, and multi-branch management. These are planned only as future phases.

3.3 Feature prioritisation

Priority uses MoSCoW (Must, Should, Could). Value and effort are scored 1-5 by the authors [A] and should be revised after interviews. Priority score = value divided by effort.

Table 12. *Feature prioritisation (scores are the authors' estimates)*

Feature	Phase	MoSCoW	Value	Effort	Score	Needs AI?
Login and dashboard	MVP	Must	5	2	2.5	No
Order add/edit/view/delete	MVP	Must	5	3	1.7	No
Order status tracking	MVP	Must	5	2	2.5	No
Customer records and history	MVP	Must	4	2	2.0	No
Product and inventory management	MVP	Must	5	3	1.7	No
Low-stock alerts	MVP	Should	4	2	2.0	No
Sales summaries and basic reports	MVP	Must	4	3	1.3	No
Expense tracking and estimated profit	MVP	Must	4	2	2.0	No

Feature	Phase	MoSCoW	Value	Effort	Score	Needs AI?
PKR currency support	MVP	Must	3	1	3.0	No
AI reply suggestions	Phase 2	Should	4	3	1.3	Yes
Urdu / English message help	Phase 2	Should	4	4	1.0	Yes
Suggested follow-ups	Phase 2	Could	3	2	1.5	Optional
AI sales summaries	Phase 2	Could	3	2	1.5	Yes
WhatsApp Business API integration	Phase 3	Could	5	5	1.0	Optional
Courier tracking integrations	Phase 3	Could	4	4	1.0	No
Payment and COD reconciliation	Phase 3	Should	4	4	1.0	No
Advanced reports and analytics	Phase 3	Could	3	4	0.8	Optional

3.4 User journey and customer workflow



Figure 4. *Seller user journey (planned MVP flow)*

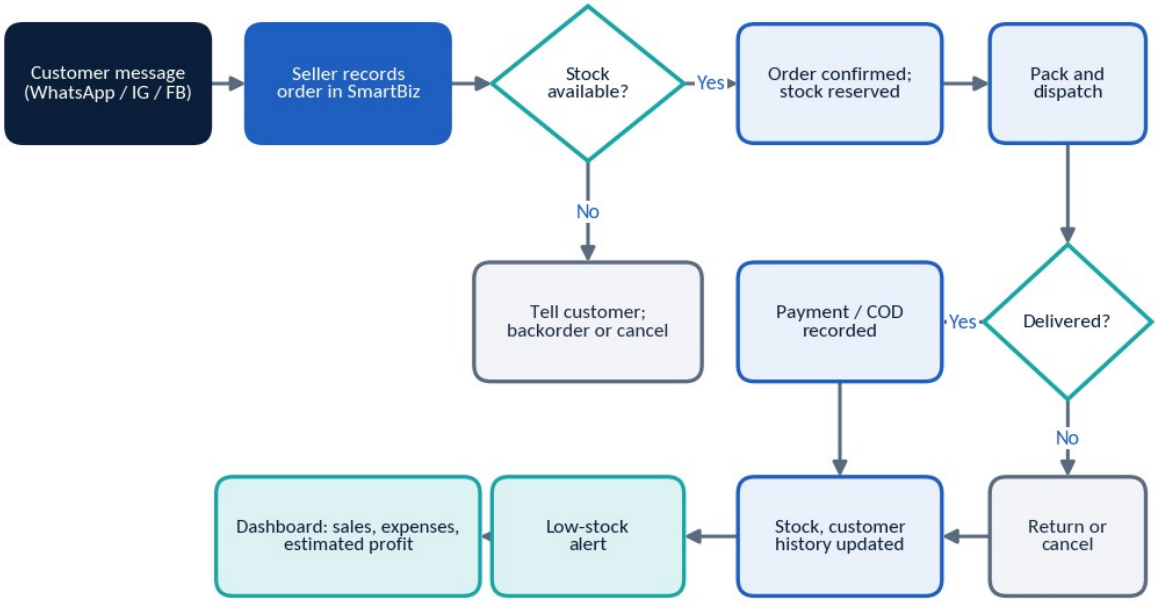


Figure 5. *Customer order management business flow (planned MVP)*

3.5 Technical architecture and technology stack

The prototype uses simple, low-cost tools so a small team can build and change it quickly. Each part has a clear upgrade path if the product succeeds.

Table 13. *Proposed technology stack*

Layer	Initial prototype / MVP	Production option	Note
Front end	Streamlit (Python)	React or similar web front end	Streamlit is fast to build but offers less control over mobile layout and multi-user behaviour.
Application logic	Python modules: auth, orders, customers, inventory, expenses, reports	FastAPI or Django service	Separate logic from screens from day one so the front end can change.
Database	SQLite	PostgreSQL (managed or self-hosted)	SQLite is simple but handles few simultaneous writers; plan the move before many users are active.
Authentication	Hashed passwords, session handling	Verified-email or phone login, rate limiting	Never store plain-text passwords. Security review before public launch.
Hosting	Small cloud server (for example a virtual private server), HTTPS	Managed cloud with staging and production	Hosting cost is set at PKR 6,000-30,000 per month by scenario [A] [Q].
Backups and monitoring	Daily database backup; uptime monitor; error logs	Automated backups, alerts, restore tests	Test restoring a backup before launch.
AI layer (Phase 2)	Optional external AI API called from the server	Provider choice and fallback	See 3.6. The product must still work if the AI service is off.
Integrations (Phase 3)	None in MVP	WhatsApp Business API, courier APIs, payment partners	Subject to approval, access, and charges.

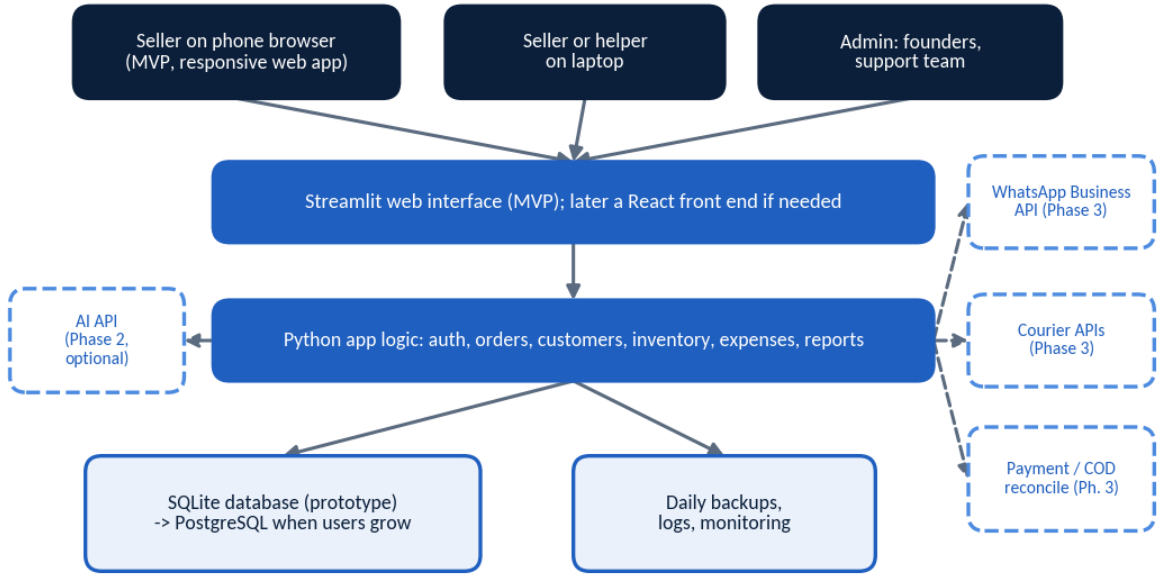


Figure 6. *Basic system architecture (solid = MVP; dashed = future phases)*

3.6 Where AI is optional and how it affects the budget

- **Works without AI (all of the MVP):** orders, customers, stock, status, expenses, profit estimates, reports, low-stock alerts, and rule-based follow-up reminders (for example, "no reply for 24 hours").
- **AI-assisted (Phase 2, optional):** reply suggestions, Urdu and English message help, follow-up wording, and plain-language summaries of sales. A seller can accept, edit, or ignore every suggestion.
- **Cost effect.** AI is billed per use by the provider. The model assumes PKR 120 per paying customer per month from month 7 [A] [Q]. The real cost depends on message volume, text length, and the provider's current price list, so Phase 2 starts with a two-week usage test and per-plan usage limits.
- **Data caution.** Messages sent to an AI provider may contain customer names and phone numbers. Send only what is needed, tell users, and check the provider's data terms (Step 8).
- **WhatsApp costs (Phase 3).** Meta charges per message and bills in US dollars. For Pakistan, one source lists US$0.0473 per marketing message and US$0.010 per utility message [V], while a September 2026 news report says Pakistan's rate for utility, authentication and service messages is US$0.015 from October 2026, with 1,000 free service messages a month [V]. At PKR 278/US$ [A] this is about PKR 13 per marketing message and PKR 3-4 per utility message [C]. These costs are **not** in the base forecast and would be passed through to customers.

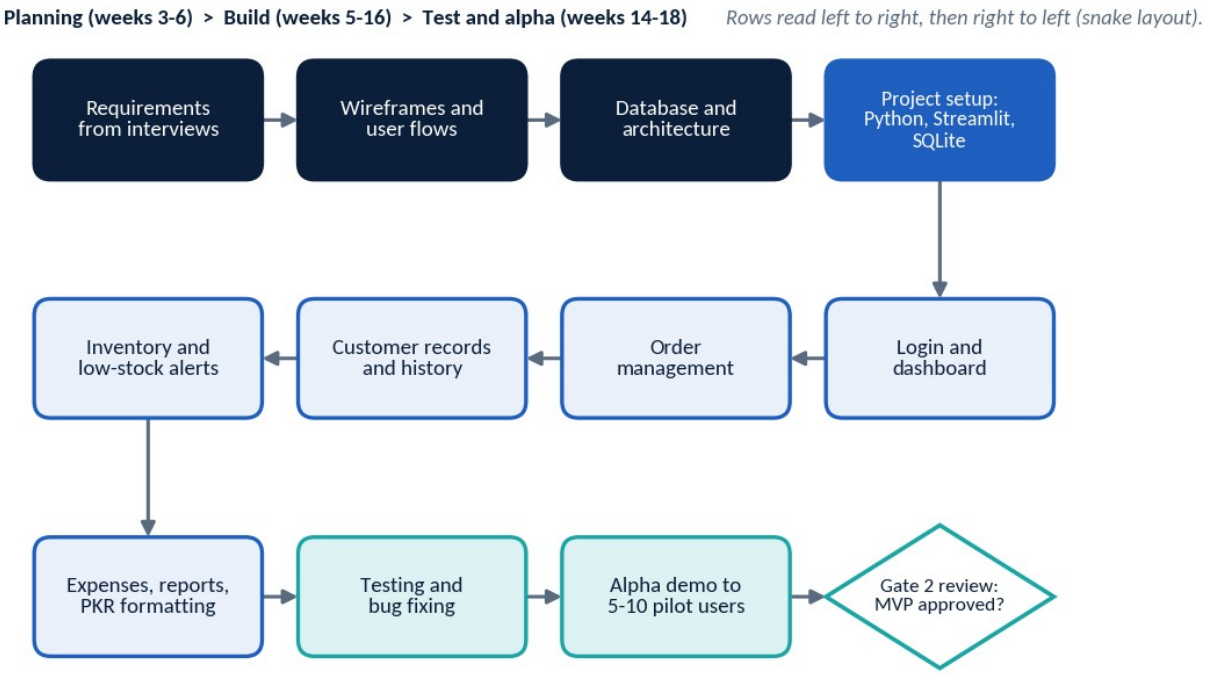


Figure 7. *MVP development flowchart*

3.7 Product roadmap

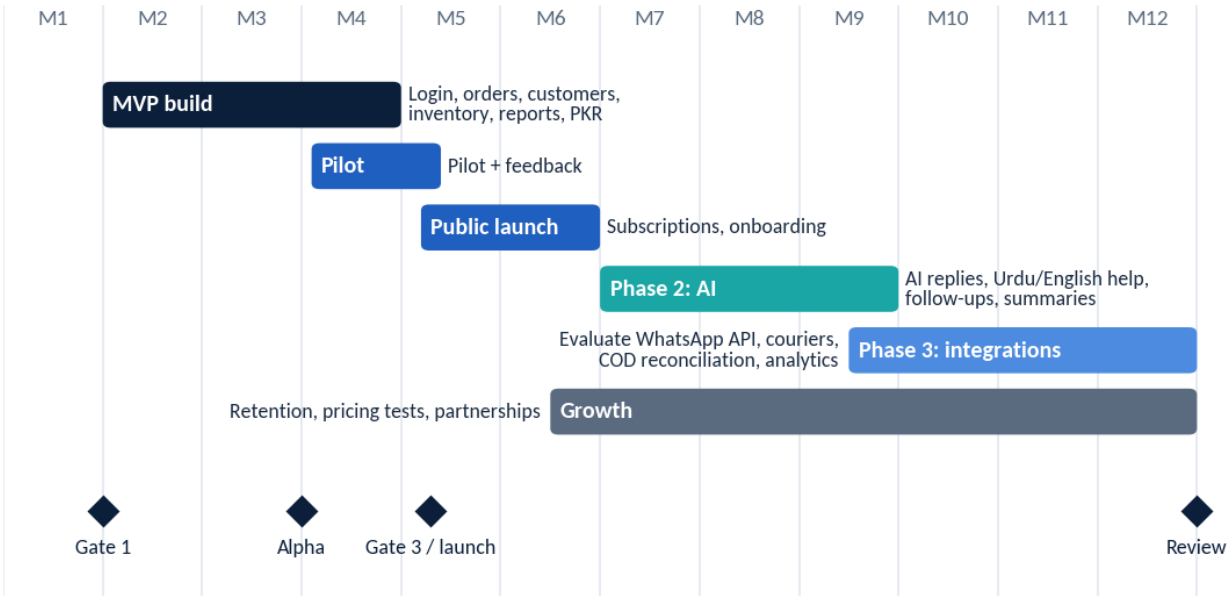


Figure 8. *Product roadmap by month (MVP, pilot, launch, Phase 2 AI, Phase 3 integrations)*

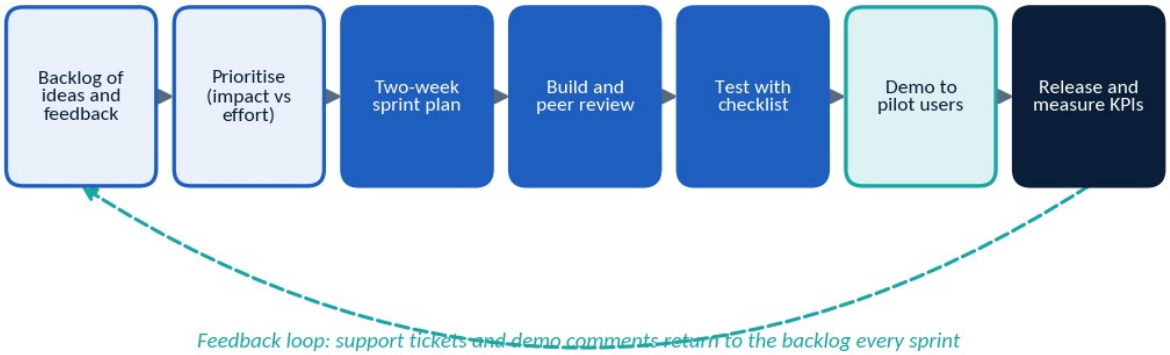


Figure 9. *Product development workflow (two-week sprint cycle)*

Step 4: Competitor Analysis and Positioning

Competitors were reviewed from their own public pages in October 2026. Dollar prices are converted at PKR 278 per US$1 [A]. "Not stated" means the reviewed page did not say, not that the feature is missing.

Table 14. *Competitor comparison (sources: official pages; see References)*

Competitor	Type	Target audience	Price and currency	Inventory / orders	AI	Local fit	Notes
WhatsApp + spreadsheets	Substitute (manual)	Almost every micro-seller	Free [V]	Manual; no stock logic	None	Fully familiar	Hard to scale, error-prone.
Zoho Inventory	Direct (global)	Small and mid-size businesses	Free (50 orders); Standard US$29 a month billed annually or US$39 monthly, 500 orders [V]; about PKR 8,100-10,800 [C]	Strong inventory and orders	Not stated	English-first, USD	More features than a micro-seller may need.
Hulm POS	Direct (local POS)	Pakistani SMEs and shops	PKR 2,500 a month, 14-day trial [V]	Order and inventory management listed	Not stated	FBR-compliant invoicing, WhatsApp support	Shop and POS oriented.
Granet Pro	Direct (local POS)	Cafes, retail counters	PKR 2,999 / 5,999 / 9,999 per branch a month [V]	Inventory in Growth plan and above	Not stated	PKR pricing	Restaurant and retail focus.
ManageKaro	Direct (local)	Retailers, distributors	PKR 10,000 a year; lifetime PKR 25,000 [V]	Inventory, POS, HR, finance	Not stated	PKR pricing	Broad business suite, not social-seller flow.
Smart Stock	Direct (local desktop/cloud)	Retailers, wholesalers, pharmacies	PKR 24,000 or 40,000 one-time; cloud add-on PKR 1,000 a month [V]	Inventory and accounting	Not stated	PKR pricing, WhatsApp share of bills	Shop-oriented; upfront cost.
Sellio	Direct (WhatsApp-first)	Bakers, boutiques, resellers	"Free to start"; paid plans not found on the page [V]	Catalog, orders, payments, follow-ups	Not stated	Built for Pakistani sellers	Closest in idea; small and new. Needs a deeper review.
CRM and storefront tools	Indirect	Businesses with larger sales teams or own websites	Not researched in this edition	Varies	Varies	Varies	Research task for week 1-3.

What the table shows. Local tools are mostly built for shops with counters (POS). Global tools are priced in dollars. A tool built around orders that arrive by chat, with PKR pricing, is a **possible** gap. Sellio suggests others see the same gap, so speed and real seller feedback matter more than the idea itself.

4.1 SWOT analysis

Table 15. *SWOT analysis (strengths and opportunities are hypotheses)*

Strengths (to be proven)	Weaknesses
- Low-cost cloud product; small team can iterate quickly - Focus on chat-based sellers, not shops - Local knowledge, PKR pricing, Urdu support planned	- No product, brand, or customers yet - Limited funds and a small team - Dependence on a few founders; Streamlit/SQLite limits at scale

Opportunities	Threats
- Social commerce growth and mobile-first buying - WhatsApp message charges push sellers to be organised - Urdu and Roman Urdu AI help is rarely built into local tools - Partnerships with couriers and payment providers	- Free alternatives (spreadsheets, WhatsApp Business app) - Competitors adding order features or cutting prices - Low willingness to pay; high churn among micro-sellers - Platform changes by Meta; rising API costs - Inflation and exchange-rate swings affect cloud and AI costs

4.2 Positioning matrix

The matrix uses two axes: affordability for a small seller (price in PKR and local billing) and ease of use for a WhatsApp or Instagram seller. Positions are the authors' judgement from public pages. They must be checked in interviews and by trying the products.



Positions are the authors' qualitative judgement from public websites; they must be validated in interviews and trials.

Figure 10. *2x2 positioning matrix: affordability versus ease of use (qualitative judgement)*

4.3 SmartBiz AI differentiation strategy (hypotheses to test)

SmartBiz AI is not assumed to be the market leader or to have a unique advantage. The ideas below are competitive-advantage hypotheses, each with a test.

Table 16. *Differentiation hypotheses and tests*

#	Hypothesis	How to test	Evidence needed
H1	Easiest start for chat-based sellers: first order recorded in under 60 seconds.	Timed first-use tests with 10 sellers.	Median time to first order below 2 minutes; 7 of 10 complete without help.
H2	PKR pricing under PKR 3,000 with a free plan beats USD tools and shop software on value.	Price-reaction questions; pilot offer.	At least 25% of activated pilot users agree to pay.
H3	Profit visibility (expenses plus estimated profit) matters more to sellers than invoicing.	Interview ranking; feature-usage logs.	Profit view used weekly by at least 40% of active users.
H4	Urdu and Roman Urdu reply help saves time (Phase 2).	AI beta with 20 users; reply-time tracking.	Median self-reported time saving above 30 minutes a week.

#	Hypothesis	How to test	Evidence needed
H5	Local onboarding by WhatsApp and Urdu support lifts activation.	Compare onboarding styles in the pilot.	Higher activation in assisted group.

Step 5: Business Model and Pricing

5.1 Options evaluated

Table 17. *Business model options*

Option	Strengths	Risks	Decision
Monthly subscription	Low entry barrier; fits small cash flows.	Higher churn; monthly payment effort.	Use as the main option.
Annual subscription	Better cash flow and retention.	Small sellers may not pay upfront.	Offer at 10 months' price (2 months free) [A].
Free plan / trial	Lowers risk; creates referrals.	Free users cost support and hosting.	Use a limited free plan (30 orders a month) and a 14-day trial of paid features [A].
Premium AI features	Clear extra value; protects margin.	AI cost per use; quality in Urdu uncertain.	Phase 2, in Growth and Business plans.
Partnerships (couriers, payments)	Possible referral income.	Depends on partner terms; none exist.	Explore after month 9. No income assumed.

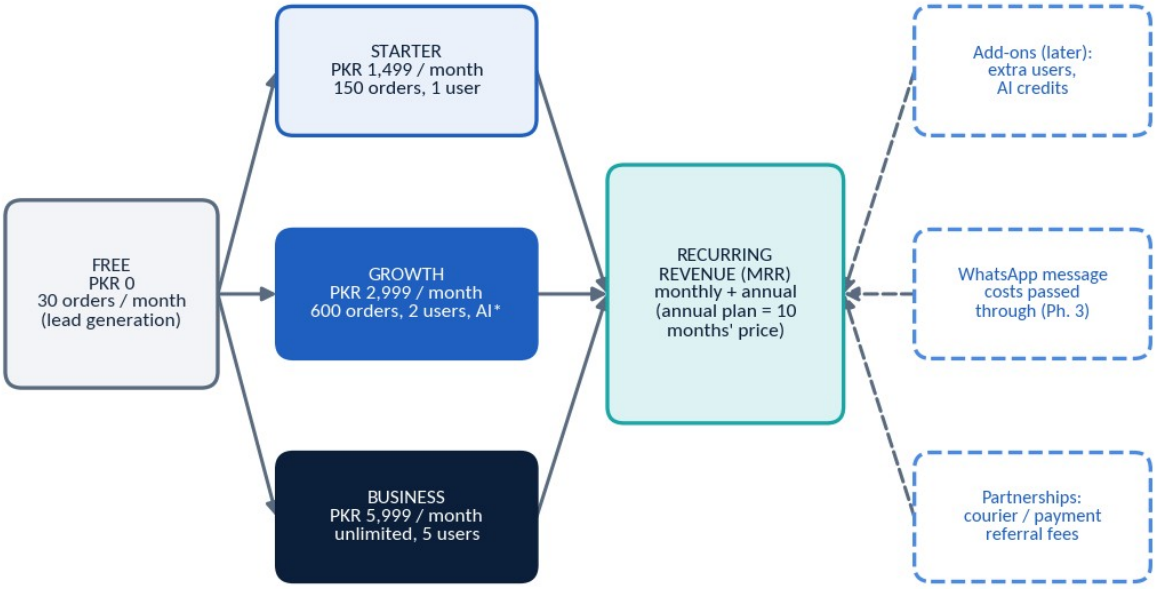
5.2 Illustrative pricing tiers (PKR per month, excluding tax)

Table 18. *Illustrative pricing tiers {A}. Final prices only after interviews and the pilot*

Plan	Price	Limits (proposed)	Features	Assumed mix
Free	PKR 0	30 orders a month, 1 user	Orders, customers, products, basic dashboard	lead generation
Starter	PKR 1,499	150 orders a month, 1 user	Full MVP: inventory, low-stock alerts, expenses, reports	50%
Growth	PKR 2,999	600 orders a month, 2 users	Starter plus advanced reports; AI assistance from Phase 2	40%
Business	PKR 5,999	Unlimited orders, 5 users	Growth plus priority support, CSV export, integrations when available	10%

Pricing logic

- **Competitor reference points.** Local entry prices found: Hulm POS PKR 2,500 a month, Granet Pro from PKR 2,999, ManageKaro PKR 10,000 a year (about PKR 833 a month [C]), Smart Stock PKR 1,000 a month for cloud after a PKR 24,000 purchase [V]. Zoho Inventory's paid entry plan is about PKR 8,100-10,800 a month [C].
- **Positioning.** Starter below local POS entry prices; Growth in line with them but focused on chat-based sellers; Business below global tools.
- **Recommendation rule.** Recommend final prices only after (1) interview price reactions, (2) pilot willingness to pay, and (3) updated competitor prices. Start with the table above and change it if fewer than 25% of activated pilot users would pay.
- **Tax.** Prices are shown excluding sales tax. Whether and at what rate tax applies to the subscription must be confirmed (Step 8).



** AI features are planned for Phase 2. Dashed boxes are future streams not included in the MVP forecast.*

Figure 11. *Revenue model: planned tiers and future revenue streams*

5.3 Financial metrics in simple English

Table 19. *Metrics, formulas and numerical examples*

Metric	Simple meaning	Formula	Example (planning assumptions)
Average revenue per customer (ARPU)	How much one paying customer pays in a typical month.	Sum of (price x share of customers on that plan)	0.5 x 1,499 + 0.4 x 2,999 + 0.1 x 5,999 = PKR 2,549 [C]
Monthly recurring revenue (MRR)	Subscription income expected every month.	Paying customers x ARPU	100 customers x 2,549 = PKR 254,900 [C]
Variable cost per customer	Cost that grows with each customer: hosting, AI, payment fees.	Hosting + AI + payment fee	60 + 120 (from month 7) + 2.5% of ARPU (64) = PKR 244 [A] [Q]
Gross margin	Money left from each customer after direct costs.	(ARPU - variable cost) / ARPU	(2,549 - 244) / 2,549 = 90.4%, or PKR 2,305 per customer [C]. Staff costs are counted separately.
Churn rate	Share of customers who cancel each month.	Customers lost in month / customers at start of month	Assumed 6% a month [A]
Customer lifetime	Average months a customer stays.	1 / churn rate	1 / 0.06 = 16.7 months [C]
Customer lifetime value (LTV)	Total gross profit expected from one customer.	Gross profit per month x lifetime	2,305 x 16.7 = about PKR 38,417 [C]
Customer acquisition cost (CAC)	Marketing and sales cost to win one paying customer.	(Marketing spend + sales/marketing staff cost) / new paying customers	Standard plan, year 1: about PKR 7,417 (Lean 5,536, Growth 6,424) [C] [A]
LTV : CAC ratio	Value created for each rupee spent on winning customers.	LTV / CAC	38,417 / 7,417 = 5.2 (Standard) [C]
Payback period	Months to earn back CAC.	CAC / gross profit per month	7,417 / 2,305 = 3.2 months [C]

> **Caution on CAC.** The CAC above is the planned marketing budget divided by planned new customers. It is a **target**, not an observed result, and it is partly circular. Real CAC is known only after the pilot and launch. Founder time is not included.

Table 20. *Sensitivity of LTV and LTV:CAC to churn (Standard plan CAC). A ratio near 3 or above is a common rule of thumb; micro-seller churn may be higher than assumed*

Monthly churn	Lifetime (months)	LTV	LTV : CAC (base CAC)	LTV : CAC (CAC x2)
4%	25.0	PKR 57,625	7.8	3.9
6%	16.7	PKR 38,417	5.2	2.6
10%	10.0	PKR 23,050	3.1	1.6
15%	6.7	PKR 15,367	2.1	1.0

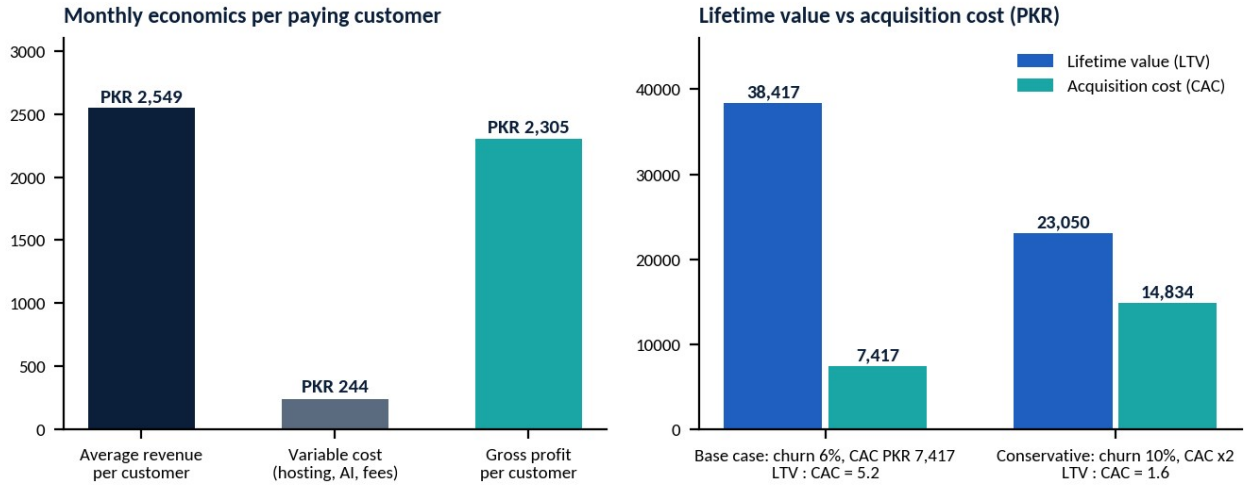


Figure 12. *Unit economics: monthly economics per customer, and LTV versus CAC (base and conservative)*

Step 6: Go-to-Market and Marketing Plan

6.1 Positioning and message

Table 21. *Positioning and message*

Element	Plan
Target segments	Segment A and B first (home-based and growing social sellers in Karachi); Segment C later.
Brand positioning	"The simple order and stock book for sellers who sell on WhatsApp and Instagram." Friendly, practical, Urdu-and-English.
Core message (to test)	"Every order in one place. Know what is pending, what is in stock, and what you earned." Draft Urdu tagline to be tested with sellers.
Proof points to collect	Pilot users' time saved, fewer missed orders, and quotes (only with permission).

6.2 Channels

Table 22. *Customer acquisition channels*

Channel	How it will be used	Notes and cautions
Seller communities	Join Karachi seller Facebook groups and WhatsApp communities as a helpful member; share order-management tips; offer free demos.	Follow each group's rules; no spamming.
Facebook and Instagram	Short Urdu/English reels and carousels (before/after of messy chats vs one dashboard); small paid campaigns to Karachi sellers aged 22-40.	Test creatives weekly; track cost per demo booked.
WhatsApp outreach	Reply to people who message the SmartBiz business number; invite pilot users personally.	Only contact people who agreed to hear from us; obtain consent; WhatsApp policies apply.
Direct outreach	Visit markets and seller meetups in person; 15-minute live demos on a phone.	Good for trust; time-intensive for founders.
Referral programme	A seller who refers another paying seller gets one free month (both sides).	Cost is a discount, not cash; cap the credits.
Partnerships	Talk to couriers, photographers, packaging and payment providers who serve the same sellers about co-promotion.	No partnerships exist; do not claim any.
Pilot testing	5-10 pilot users from week 13; weekly check-ins; testimonials with consent.	Pilot users get free use for the pilot period.

6.3 Sales funnel and how each stage is measured

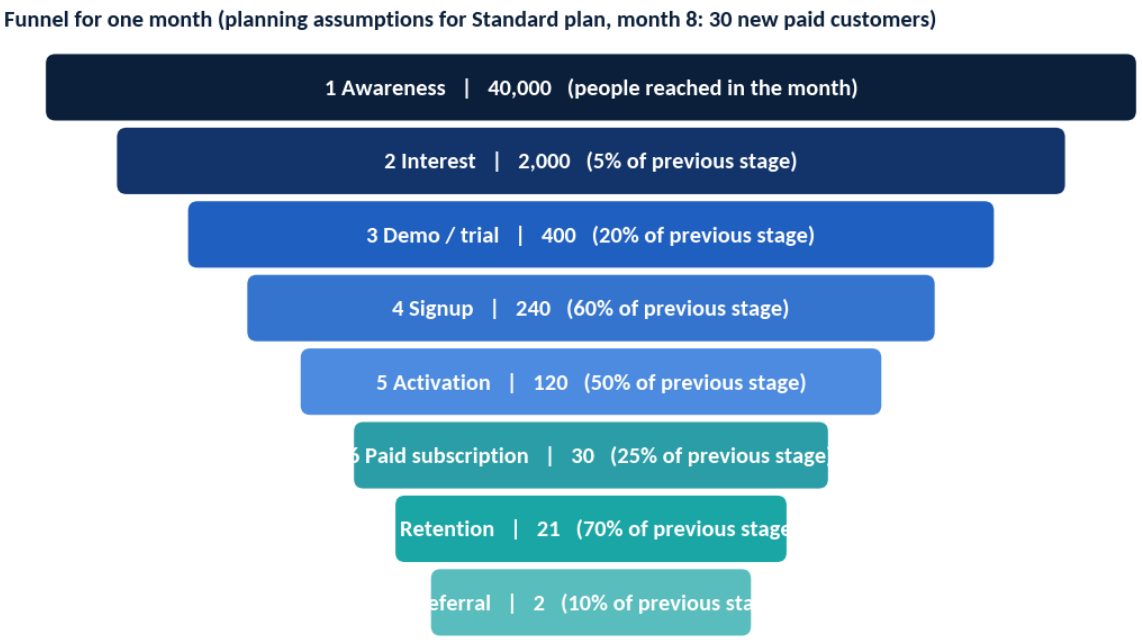


Figure 13. *Sales funnel with illustrative monthly numbers for one month of the Standard plan (planning assumptions, not results)*

Table 23. *Funnel stage definitions and measurement*

Stage	Definition	Metric	Source	Frequency
Awareness	Person sees an ad, post or referral.	Reach; cost per 1,000 reached	Meta Business Suite	Weekly
Interest	Clicks, messages, or joins a seller group.	Click-through rate; messages received	Meta, WhatsApp Business	Weekly
Demo or trial	Books a demo or starts a trial.	Demos booked; booking rate	Calendar, product log	Weekly
Signup	Creates an account.	Signups; demo-to-signup rate	Product database	Weekly
Activation	Records 5+ orders within 14 days.	Activation rate	Product database	Weekly
Paid subscription	Pays for a plan.	Free-to-paid rate; MRR	Payment records	Weekly
Retention	Still paying after 3 months.	Churn; 3-month retention	Payment records	Monthly
Referral	Brings another seller who signs up.	Referrals per 100 customers	Referral code log	Monthly

The funnel numbers are planning assumptions. They show what must be true to win 30 customers in one month: about 40,000 people reached, 5% interested, 20% of them booking a demo or trial, 60% signing up, 50% activating, and 25% paying. If real conversion is lower, the marketing budget or the timeline must change.

6.4 Marketing budgets

Table 24. *Marketing budget (Standard plan). Lean uses PKR 20,000-30,000 a month; Growth PKR 80,000-200,000 a month*

Period	Item	Budget (Standard plan, PKR)	Basis
Days 1-90 (pre-launch)	Pilot recruitment: community time, small ad tests, demo materials	40,000	[A]
Months 5-7 (public launch, 90 days)	Paid Facebook and Instagram ads	120,000	[A] [Q]
	Content and creative (reels, templates, Urdu copy)	40,000	[A] [Q]
	Seller community events and meetups	40,000	[A]

Period	Item	Budget (Standard plan, PKR)	Basis
	Referral rewards and trial incentives	30,000	[A]
	Tools (scheduler, analytics, WhatsApp Business set-up)	10,000	[A]
Launch quarter total		**240,000**	[C]
Months 9-12	Continuing campaigns	60,000 a month	[A]

90-day launch marketing plan

Table 25. *90-day launch marketing plan (months 5-7). Targets are proposals*

Days	Focus	Key activities	Owner	Target [A]
1-30	Prepare	Finish positioning; create 6 posts and 2 short videos; set up business WhatsApp number, Facebook page and Instagram; prepare demo script and sign-up page.	Marketing executive	Assets ready; 100 follow-ups
31-60	Launch campaigns	Run two small ad campaigns (PKR 40,000); join 10 seller communities; book 2 live demo sessions a week; start referral invitations.	Marketing + CEO	150 demos or trials booked
61-90	Convert and learn	Follow up every trial by WhatsApp call; onboard in 14 days; collect testimonials; drop the weakest channel; double the best.	Sales and support	20 paid customers (cumulative)

6.5 Onboarding, support and retention

- **Onboarding:** welcome message on WhatsApp within an hour; guided setup of the first 10 products; first 5 orders within 14 days; a short Urdu video guide.
- **Support:** WhatsApp and email, working hours, first reply target under 4 hours; every bug logged and tagged.
- **Retention:** weekly summary message, monthly check-in call for Growth and Business users, annual-plan offer after 3 months, and a simple cancellation survey to learn why users leave.

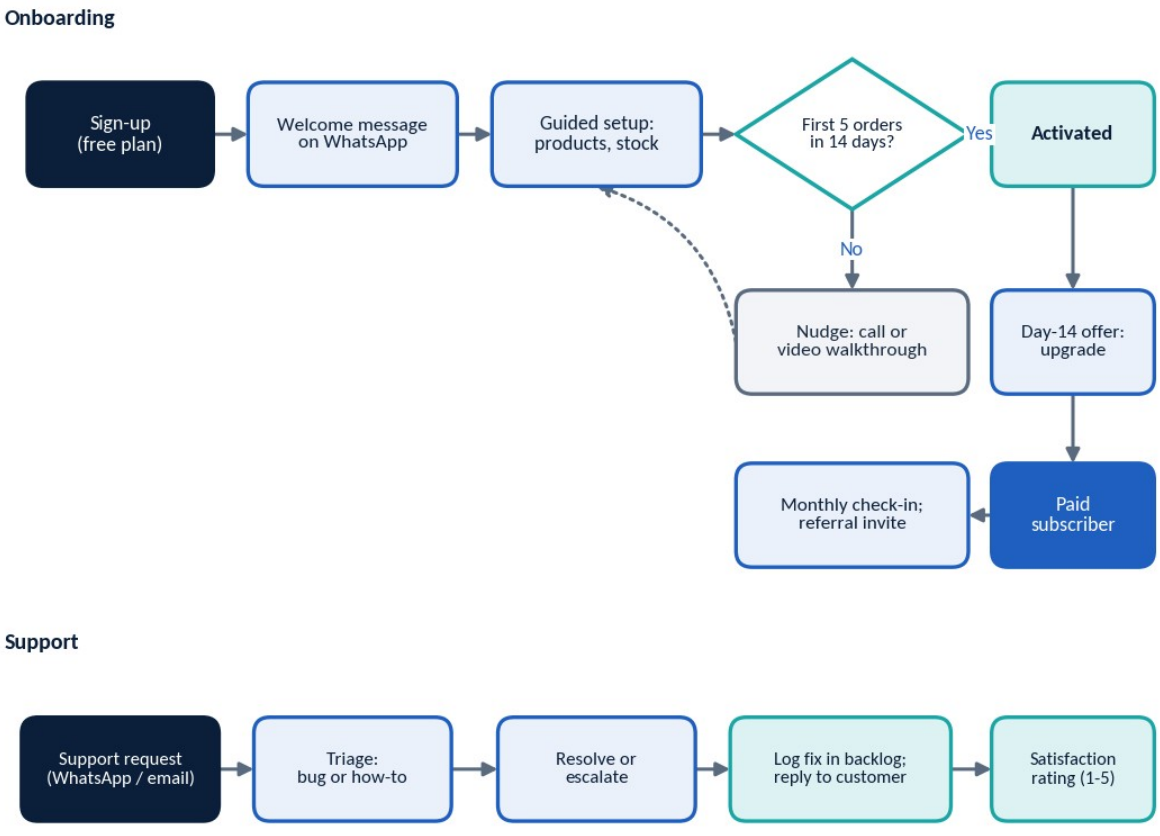


Figure 14. *Customer onboarding and support workflow*

Step 7: Operations and Team Structure

Not every role is hired at the start. The minimum MVP team is two founders (CEO/product owner and technical lead) plus one developer (a founder, a contractor, or one full-time hire), with accounting, design, and legal review outsourced.

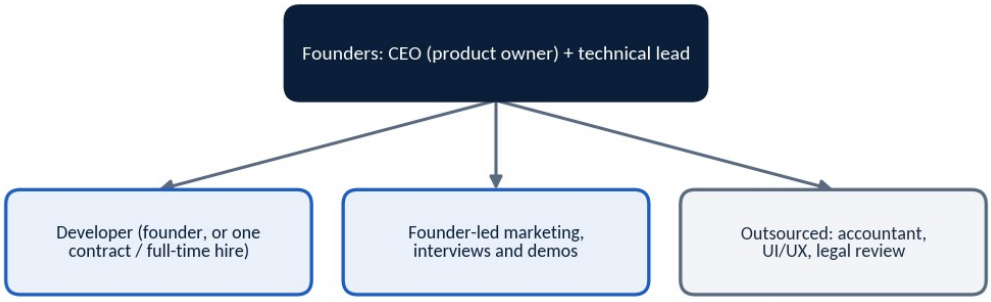


Figure 15. *Minimum team required for the MVP*

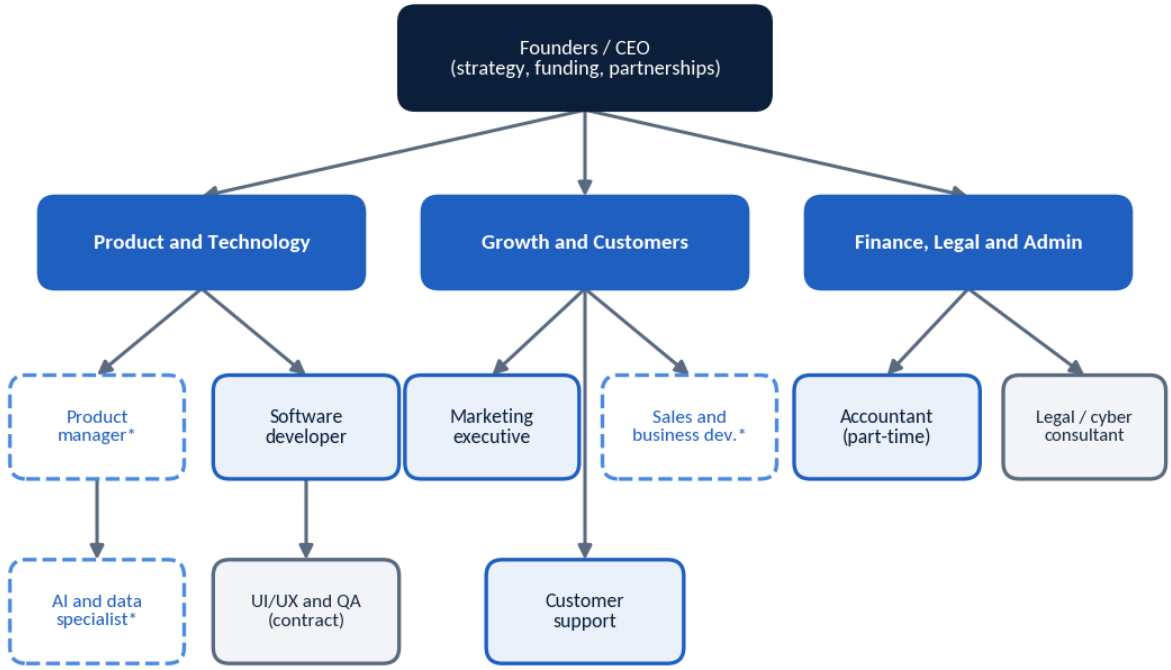
7.1 Roles, responsibilities and indicative pay

Pay figures are monthly planning benchmarks in PKR [A] [Q]. Salary sources show wide ranges: entry-level software engineers typically earn about PKR 50,000-100,000 and mid-level PKR 100,000-250,000 a month, with a Karachi average near PKR 86,667 [V]. Check against actual offers.

Table 26. *Role definitions (staffing and pay match the financial model)*

Role	Responsibilities	Key skills	Status by scenario (Lean / Standard / Growth)	Monthly PKR	Reports to	KPIs
Founder / CEO	Strategy, funding, interviews, partnerships, pricing.	Leadership, selling, finance basics	Founder-led / founder-led / stipend	0 / 0 / 60,000 each	Board / investors	Gates passed; runway; MRR
Product manager	Specification, backlog, pilot feedback.	Product discovery, writing	Founder / founder / full-time	0 / 0 / 130,000	CEO	Features shipped; activation
Software developer	Build, test, deploy, fix.	Python, SQL, web basics, security	Founder + contractor / full-time / lead + 1 developer	60,000 (3 mo) / 110,000 / 180,000 + 110,000	Product manager or CEO	Sprint delivery; bug rate; uptime
AI and data specialist	Prompts, evaluation, cost control, reports.	Prompt design, Urdu text, data	Not hired / contractor later / part-time from month 6	0 / 0 / 90,000	Product manager	AI cost per customer; suggestion acceptance
Marketing manager or executive	Campaigns, content, community, analytics.	Social media, copywriting, ads	Freelance part-time / part-time / full-time manager	25,000 / 45,000 / 100,000	CEO	Demos booked; CAC
Sales and business development	Demos, partnerships, closing paid plans.	Selling, Urdu/English	Combined with support / combined with support / 2 hires	in support role / 55,000 / 120,000 (2)	CEO	Free-to-paid rate; MRR added
Customer support	Onboarding, tickets, retention calls.	Empathy, Urdu/English, product knowledge	Part-time / combined with sales / 2 hires	35,000 / in sales role / 90,000 (2)	CEO	First reply time; CSAT; churn
Finance and administration	Bookkeeping, payments, filings, budget tracking.	Accounting, tax filing	Outsourced / outsourced / full-time	10,000 / 15,000 / 45,000	CEO	On-time filings; budget variance

Role	Responsibilities	Key skills	Status by scenario (Lean / Standard / Growth)	Monthly PKR	Reports to	KPIs
Legal / cybersecurity consultant	Contracts, privacy notice, security review.	Pakistani law; application security	Project basis / project basis / retainer	one-time / one-time / 30,000	CEO	Documents ready; issues fixed



Solid light = core hire (Standard plan). Dashed (*) = Growth plan only. Grey = contract or outsourced.

Figure 16. *Professional organisation chart and team hierarchy (target structure for the Growth plan)*

7.2 Responsibility assignment matrix (RACI)

R = Responsible (does the work), A = Accountable (final decision), C = Consulted, I = Informed. In small teams one person may hold several roles.

Table 27. *Implementation responsibility matrix*

Activity	CEO	Product / tech lead	Developer	Marketing	Support / sales	Finance
Customer interviews	A	R	I	R	C	I
Competitor research	A	R	I	R	C	I
Product specification	A	R	C	C	C	I
UI design	C	A	R	C	C	I
Build and test MVP	I	A	R	I	C	I
Pilot recruitment and demos	A	C	I	R	R	I
Pricing decisions	A	C	I	C	C	R
Marketing campaigns	A	I	I	R	C	C
Customer support	I	C	C	I	A/R	I
Budget approval and payments	A	C	I	C	I	R

Activity	CEO	Product / tech lead	Developer	Marketing	Support / sales	Finance
Legal, tax and privacy compliance	A	C	C	C	I	R
Security and backups	I	A	R	I	I	I

7.3 Operating workflows

Table 28. *Daily, weekly and monthly operating workflows*

Frequency	Workflow
Daily	15-minute stand-up; reply to messages and tickets; check server health and backups; update the task board; record spending.
Weekly	Sprint review and planning (every 2 weeks); review funnel numbers; pilot or customer calls; content publishing; budget vs actual check.
Monthly	Close the books; review KPIs, cash, and runway; review churn reasons; update competitor prices; update risk register; report to funders.
Quarterly	Pricing review; roadmap review; security and backup restore test; legal and tax compliance check.

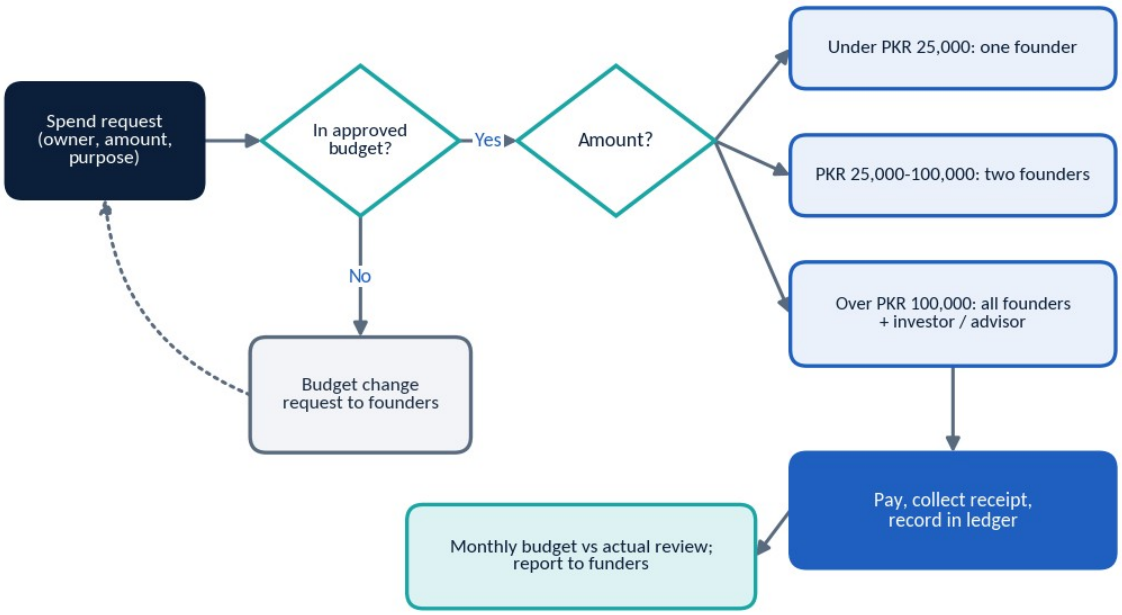


Figure 17. *Funding and expenditure approval workflow*

7.4 Recommended tools

Table 29. *Recommended tools (prices not verified; confirm before purchase)*

Purpose	Suggested tool type (examples)	Note
Team communication	WhatsApp group, Google Workspace	Check current prices.
Task and sprint board	Trello, Notion, or GitHub Projects	Free tiers usually suffice at first.
Code and deployment	GitHub, Python virtual environments, automated tests	Private repository.
Design	Figma	Free tier for early wireframes.
Customer messaging	WhatsApp Business app, Meta Business Suite	Business API only in Phase 3.
Analytics and uptime	Simple event log in the product; free uptime monitor	Avoid collecting more data than needed.

Purpose	Suggested tool type (examples)	Note
Bookkeeping	Spreadsheet plus outsourced accountant	Move to accounting software when volume grows.

Step 8: Legal, Regulatory, Security and Risk Plan

This is general information, not legal or tax advice. Pakistani law, tax rates, and platform rules change. Items below are sorted into three groups: **Confirmed** (supported by the sources reviewed), **Conditional** (depends on facts such as company type or turnover), and **Adviser needed** (a qualified Pakistani professional must decide).

Table 30. *Legal, regulatory and security considerations (sources: SECP/FBR guides, Sindh tax sources, data-protection reviews, Meta pricing documentation)*

Area	What the sources say	Status	Action
Legal structure	Sole proprietors and most partnerships do not incorporate with SECP but may still need an NTN. A single-member or private limited company registers with SECP through its eServices portal and gives a separate legal entity [V]. Indicative government fees range from about PKR 1,000 to 3,500 depending on capital and filing route [V]; professional fees are extra [Q].	Confirmed (general) / Conditional	Validate as a founder-owned sole proprietorship or partnership if cash is very tight; incorporate (Private Limited or SMC) before taking customer payments or outside investment. Adviser to confirm.
Tax registration	FBR registration yields an NTN, which is needed for a business bank account, invoices, and tax filing [V]. Income tax on business profit applies.	Confirmed (NTN) / Adviser needed (rates)	Obtain NTN; engage an accountant; keep records from day 1.
Sales tax on subscriptions	Services are taxed by provinces. The general Sindh rate on services is 15% [V]. One secondary guide says IT and software-as-a-service may have reduced rates (3-8% in Sindh); this was not confirmed from the Sindh Revenue Board in this review.	Adviser needed	Ask a tax adviser whether and when to register with the Sindh Revenue Board, and at what rate. Prices in this plan exclude tax.
Banking and accounting	A business account normally needs the NTN and registration papers.	Conditional	Open a separate business account before charging customers; keep separate books.
Contracts and subscription terms	Terms of service and subscription terms should be accepted by an explicit click. Courts' treatment of online terms should be confirmed.	Adviser needed	Lawyer to draft terms: price, renewal, cancellation, refunds, acceptable use, liability limits.
Privacy and consent	Pakistan had no comprehensive personal-data-protection law in force in the sources reviewed (2026); the Personal Data Protection Bill had not been enacted [V]. The Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act 2016 (amended) still applies to electronic offences. The position may change.	Confirmed (no general law yet) / Adviser needed	Adopt good practice anyway: plain-language privacy notice, collect only needed data, consent for messages, deletion on request. Monitor the bill.
Personal data and cybersecurity	Customer names, phone numbers, and addresses will be stored.	Conditional	Hash passwords, use HTTPS, restrict access, encrypt backups, log access, run a security check before launch, and prepare a breach response plan.
Intellectual property	Code, brand, and content are assets. Contractor work needs written assignment.	Adviser needed	Written IP assignment from every founder, employee, and contractor; check the name; consider trade-mark registration through the Intellectual Property Organisation of Pakistan.
Software licensing	Open-source parts (for example Streamlit, SQLite, PostgreSQL) have their own licences.	Conditional	Keep a list of libraries and licences; comply with attribution terms.
Electronic communications and platform policies	WhatsApp Business Platform needs approval and per-message fees, and requires user opt-in; Meta changes rates, including a change due 1 October 2026 [V]. Facebook and Instagram have their own advertising and commerce rules.	Confirmed (platform rules exist) / Adviser needed (local anti-spam law)	Read current Meta terms before Phase 3; get opt-in before any marketing message.
Payment processing and integrations	Collecting subscription money needs a bank or licensed payment provider; courier and WhatsApp integrations need provider approval and may charge.	Conditional	Use a licensed provider; do not hold customer funds; get written terms and fees [Q].

8.1 Risk register

Probability (P) and impact (I): L = low, M = medium, H = high, set by the authors [A]. Owners are roles, not named people.

Table 31. *Risk register*

#	Risk	P	I	Mitigation	Owner	Contingency
1	Market: sellers do not see enough pain or will not pay.	M	H	30 interviews; paper prototype; gates before spending.	CEO	Narrow segment, change product, or stop after Gate 1.
2	Customer retention: high churn among micro-sellers.	H	H	Onboarding to 5 orders; weekly summaries; annual plans.	Support	Fix top churn reason; lower the entry price.
3	Competition: competitors add similar features or cut prices.	M	M	Stay close to sellers; ship fast; own the chat-seller niche.	CEO	Differentiate on service and language; reprice.
4	Financial: funds run out before break-even.	M	H	Staged funding; monthly cash review; 15% reserve; hire only on revenue.	CEO / finance	Cut marketing; pause hires; bridge funding.
5	Financial: cost increases from inflation or dollar-priced cloud and AI.	M	M	Budget in PKR with buffer; usage caps; annual plans.	Finance	Adjust prices; switch providers.
6	Technical: SQLite or Streamlit limits cause slowness or data issues.	M	M	Separate logic from UI; plan PostgreSQL move; load test.	Tech lead	Migrate earlier than planned.
7	Technical: data loss.	L	H	Daily backups; restore tests.	Developer	Restore from backup; notify users.
8	Cybersecurity: breach of customer data.	M	H	Security review; access control; encryption; minimal data.	Tech lead	Breach response plan; notify users; legal advice.
9	Legal: unclear tax, privacy, or contract obligations.	M	M	Adviser review before launch; written terms; monitor law changes.	CEO / finance	Adviser-led correction; register late if required.
10	Platform dependence: Meta changes WhatsApp or ads rules and prices.	M	M	Do not depend on WhatsApp API for core value; pass costs on.	Product	Re-scope Phase 3.
11	Operational: founder overload or team conflict.	M	M	Written roles, equity and decision rules; weekly review.	CEO	Bring in an adviser; adjust roles.
12	Operational: key developer leaves.	M	H	Documentation; code in shared repository; second developer on core.	Tech lead	Contract replacement.
13	AI quality and cost (Phase 2): poor Urdu output or high cost.	M	M	Usage test; human approval; per-plan caps; AI is optional.	AI specialist	Limit or remove AI features.
14	Market: economic or power and internet disruption.	M	M	Mobile-friendly; save drafts; clear outage communication.	Ops	Support by phone; extend billing dates.

Step 9: Execution Timeline and Gantt Chart

Start date. No start date was supplied, so Day 1 is Week 1, Day 1. Week n covers Days 7n-6 to 7n. Month m covers about Weeks 4.33(m-1)+1 to 4.33m. If the real start is, for example, 1 January, add the week offsets to that date.

The plan is built for a small team of two founders plus a developer. Work that can run in parallel is shown as overlapping bars; work that cannot start until earlier work is finished is linked by arrows.

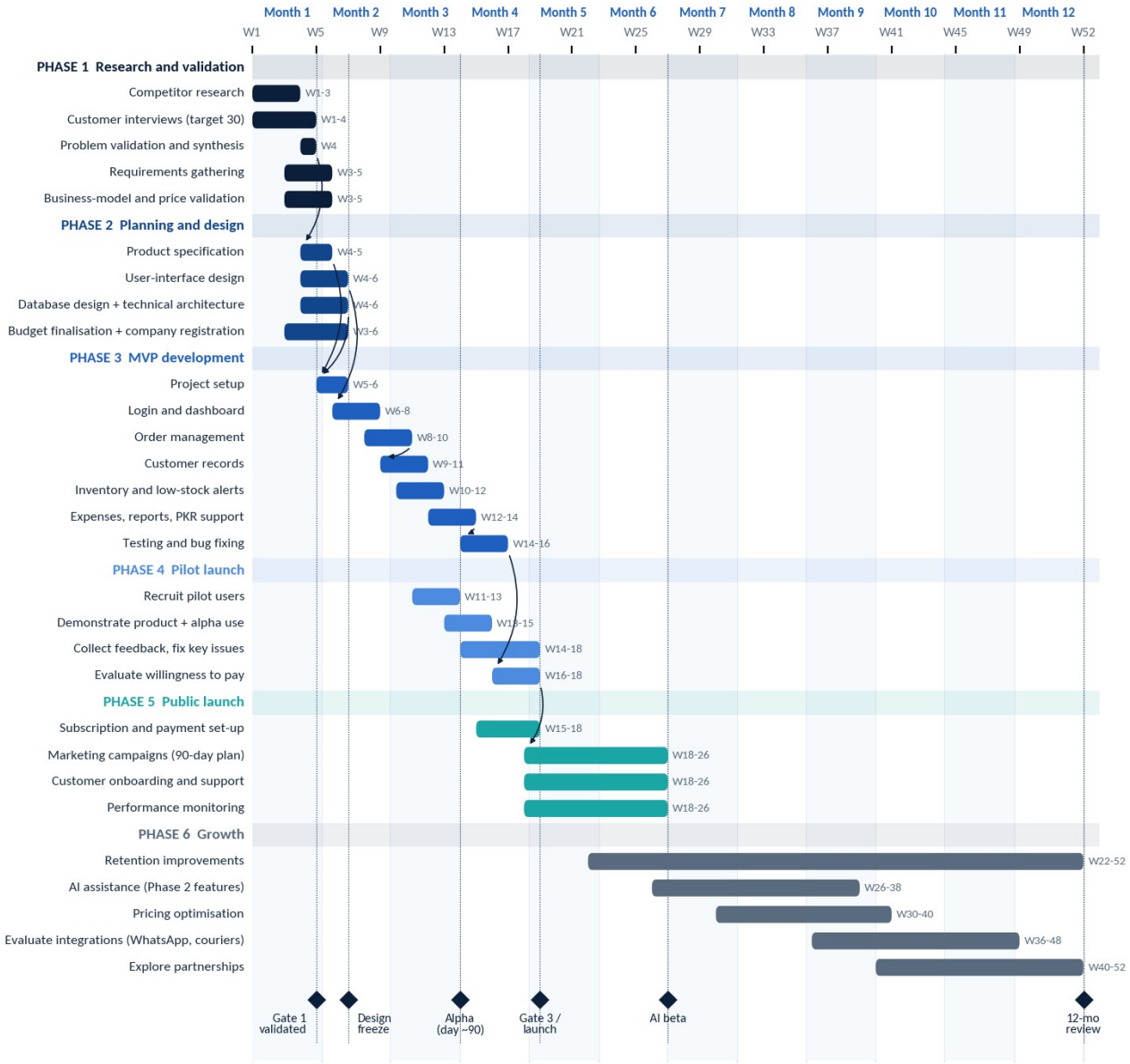


Figure 18. *Gantt chart: 52-week plan with dependencies (arrows) and milestones (diamonds)*

9.1 Task schedule, owners, dependencies and deliverables

Table 32. *Detailed schedule with dependencies (Phase 1-6)*

ID	Task	Ph.	Weeks	Owner	Depends on	Deliverable
T1	Competitor research	1	1-3	Founder / PM	-	Competitor sheet with dated prices
T2	Customer interviews (30)	1	1-4	CEO + marketer	-	30 interview notes; summary
T3	Problem validation	1	4	CEO	T2	Validation memo (Gate 1)

ID	Task	Ph.	Weeks	Owner	Depends on	Deliverable
T4	Requirements gathering	1	3-5	PM / tech lead	T2 (partial)	Requirements list
T5	Business model and price validation	1	3-5	CEO	T1, T2	Price table v2
T6	Product specification	2	4-5	PM	T3	MVP specification
T7	User-interface design	2	4-6	UI/UX contract	T4	Clickable prototype
T8	Database and technical architecture	2	4-6	Tech lead	T4	Schema; architecture note
T9	Budget finalisation and registration	2	3-6	CEO / finance	T5	Approved budget; NTN and registration filed
T10	Project setup	3	5-6	Developer	T6, T8	Repository, environment, CI checks
T11	Login and dashboard	3	6-8	Developer	T7, T10	Working login and dashboard
T12	Order management	3	8-10	Developer	T11	Order create/edit/status
T13	Customer records	3	9-11	Developer	T12	Customer list and history
T14	Inventory and low-stock alerts	3	10-12	Developer	T12	Stock logic and alerts
T15	Expenses, reports, PKR support	3	12-14	Developer	T12-T14	Reports; profit estimate
T16	Testing and bug fixing	3	14-16	Developer + QA	T15	Test report; Gate 2 pack
T17	Recruit pilot users	4	11-13	Marketer	T7	5-10 confirmed pilot users
T18	Demonstrate product; alpha use	4	13-15	CEO	T17, T14	Pilot accounts live
T19	Collect feedback; fix key issues	4	14-18	PM / developer	T18	Feedback log; fixes
T20	Evaluate willingness to pay	4	16-18	CEO	T18	WTP report (Gate 3)
T21	Subscription and payment set-up	5	15-18	Developer / finance	T9	Billing flow; terms live
T22	Marketing campaigns	5	18-26	Marketer	T20	Campaign results
T23	Customer onboarding and support	5	18-26	Support	T16	Support playbook in use
T24	Performance monitoring	5	18-26	PM	T16	Weekly KPI dashboard
T25	Retention improvements	6	22-52	PM / support	T23	Churn reduction actions
T26	AI assistance (Phase 2)	6	26-38	Developer / AI	T24, usage test	AI beta
T27	Pricing optimisation	6	30-40	CEO	T22	Revised price table
T28	Evaluate integrations	6	36-48	Tech lead	T26	Integration decision memo
T29	Explore partnerships	6	40-52	CEO / sales	T27	Partnership shortlist

Tasks that can run in parallel

- T1, T2, T4, T5, and T9 (weeks 1-6): research, requirements, pricing, and registration paperwork.
- T7 (UI design) and T8 (database design) with T6 (specification).
- T13 and T14 overlap T12 once the order data model exists.
- T17 (pilot recruitment) runs while T12-T15 are being built; T21 (billing) runs while the pilot is in progress.

Tasks that depend on earlier work

- No build spending beyond design before Gate 1 (T3).
- T22 (public marketing) waits for T20 and Gate 3.
- T26 (AI) waits for stable core operation and a usage-cost test.

9.2 Milestone approval criteria

Table 33. *Milestone approval criteria*

Milestone / gate	Week	Approval criteria (proposed)	Approver
Gate 1: validation	4	At least 20 of 30 sellers rank order tracking or stock confusion in their top three problems; at least 10 sellers willing to pilot; price range acceptable to 8 or more.	All founders
Design freeze	6	Specification and prototype reviewed by 5 or more sellers; budget approved; registration filed.	Founders
Alpha (about day 90)	13	Core order, customer, and stock flows pass the test checklist; 5-10 pilot users onboarded.	Founders
Gate 2: MVP quality	16	No critical bugs; backup restore tested; security checklist complete; support playbook ready.	Tech lead + CEO
Gate 3: launch decision	18	7 of 10 pilot users activated; at least 25% of activated users would pay; terms, privacy notice, and billing ready; cash runway of 6 months or more.	Founders + funder
AI beta	26	Usage test shows AI cost within the assumed PKR 120 per customer a month, or plan limits adjusted; 20 beta users agree.	CEO + tech lead
12-month review	52	KPI review against Step 11; funding decision for year 2.	Founders + funder

9.3 30-, 60- and 90-day plans

Table 34. *30-60-90 day plan*

Period	Goals	Main activities	Deliverables
Days 1-30 (weeks 1-4)	Learn and validate.	Agree roles and decision rules; competitor research; 30 interviews; start registration; draft price table.	Interview summary; competitor sheet; Gate 1 memo.
Days 31-60 (weeks 5-8)	Design and start building.	Specification; wireframes and prototype; database design; project setup; login, dashboard, start of orders; collect pilot commitments.	Approved design; working login and dashboard; 10 pilot commitments.
Days 61-90 (weeks 9-13)	Core build and alpha.	Orders, customers, inventory; recruit pilot users; demos; start alpha with 5-10 users.	Alpha live; first feedback log.

9.4 Month-by-month 12-month roadmap

Table 35. *Month-by-month roadmap (customer and revenue numbers are forecasts, not results)*

Month	Weeks	Key work	Paying customers (Standard forecast)	Monthly revenue (PKR)
M1	1-4	Validate problem; interviews; registration; competitor research.	0	0
M2	5-8	Design, specification, architecture; project setup; start build.	0	0
M3	9-13	Build orders, customers, inventory; recruit pilot users; alpha at week 13.	0	0
M4	14-17	Reports, expenses, testing; pilot feedback; Gate 2.	0	0
M5	18-22	Gate 3; public launch; subscriptions; first paying customers.	6	15,294
M6	23-26	Campaigns; onboarding; support playbook; weekly KPI review.	16	39,866
M7	27-30	AI beta planning and usage test; retention work.	29	73,160
M8	31-35	AI assistance released to Growth users; pricing tests.	45	114,653
M9	36-39	Review results; plan integrations; start partnership talks.	63	161,303
M10	40-43	Integration evaluation (WhatsApp, couriers); pricing update.	84	212,800
M11	44-48	Hiring decision based on revenue; partnership shortlist.	106	268,855

Month	Weeks	Key work	Paying customers (Standard forecast)	Monthly revenue (PKR)
M12	49-52	12-month review; year-2 plan and funding decision.	129	329,194

A complete, renderable Mermaid version of the Gantt chart is in Appendix B for editing in documentation tools.

Step 10: Financial Plan and Investment Requirements

> **Forecasts, not guarantees.** All figures are planning scenarios in PKR built from labelled assumptions. Revenue is not profit, and profit is not cash. Taxes (income tax and sales tax) are **not** included. Founders are unpaid in the Lean and Standard plans, which is a real cost and a risk.

10.1 Key assumptions

Table 36. *Core financial assumptions (full list in Appendix A)*

Assumption	Value	Basis
Prices (Starter / Growth / Business)	PKR 1,499 / 2,999 / 5,999 a month, ex-tax	[A]
Plan mix	50% / 40% / 10%; ARPU PKR 2,549	[A] [C]
Paid sales begin	Month 5 (after pilot and Gate 3)	[A]
Monthly churn	6%, applied from month 6	[A]
Hosting per customer	PKR 60 a month	[A] [Q]
AI cost per customer	PKR 120 a month from month 7	[A] [Q]
Payment processing	2.5% of revenue	[A] [Q]
Billing	All customers pay monthly in advance; no annual prepayments assumed (conservative)	[A]
Salaries	Benchmarks from job-site salary averages for Pakistan and Karachi (see Step 7)	[V] [A] [Q]
One-time costs	Booked in month 1 for simplicity (conservative); real timing will spread over months 1-4	[A] [Q]
Contingency	15% of the peak cumulative cash shortfall	[A]
Exchange rate	PKR 278 per US$1, for reference only	[A]
Excluded	Income tax, sales tax, WhatsApp API pass-through costs, founder salaries (Lean and Standard), interest	-

10.2 Three funding scenarios

Table 37. *Scenario comparison. Costs are planning estimates {A}{Q}; the 'one-time development' row is a subset of one-time costs plus contract developer fees*

PKR unless stated	Lean / Minimum Budget	Standard Small Startup	Higher-Investment Growth Plan
Initial investment (one-time costs)	150,000	475,000	1,225,000
Monthly operating cost at month 6 (fixed run-rate)	122,000	347,000	1,345,000
Monthly fixed cost at month 12	122,000	327,000	1,345,000
One-time development and design (outsourced)	250,000	260,000	400,000
Marketing budget (12 months)	290,000	640,000	1,780,000
Staffing budget (12 months)	805,000	2,455,000	10,270,000
Technology budget (hosting, tools; 12 months)	168,000	324,000	840,000
Admin and legal (12 months, excl. one-time)	96,000	180,000	720,000
Variable costs (12 months)	77,543	113,588	304,546
Revenue forecast (12 months)	833,181	1,215,125	3,239,413

PKR unless stated	Lean / Minimum Budget	Standard Small Startup	Higher-Investment Growth Plan
Peak cumulative cash shortfall	871,334	2,972,463	11,900,133
Contingency reserve (15%)	130,700	445,869	1,785,020
Total funding requirement (rounded up)	**1,050,000**	**3,450,000**	**13,700,000**
Approximate US dollars	US$3,777	US$12,410	US$49,281
Estimated runway with zero revenue (months)	7.4	8.6	9.3
Lowest forecast cash balance after funding	178,666 (M9)	477,537 (M12)	1,799,867 (M12)

How the funding requirement is calculated: run the monthly cash flow with no funding; take the lowest cumulative point (the peak shortfall); add 15% as contingency; round up to the next PKR 50,000. Runway with zero revenue = (funding minus one-time costs) divided by the month-6 fixed run-rate. It shows how long cash would last if no customer ever paid.

Recommended release of money (Standard plan): about 10% before Gate 1 (interviews, registration, design deposit); about 45% after Gate 1 for design and the MVP build through alpha; the balance after Gate 3 for launch marketing and further hires [A].

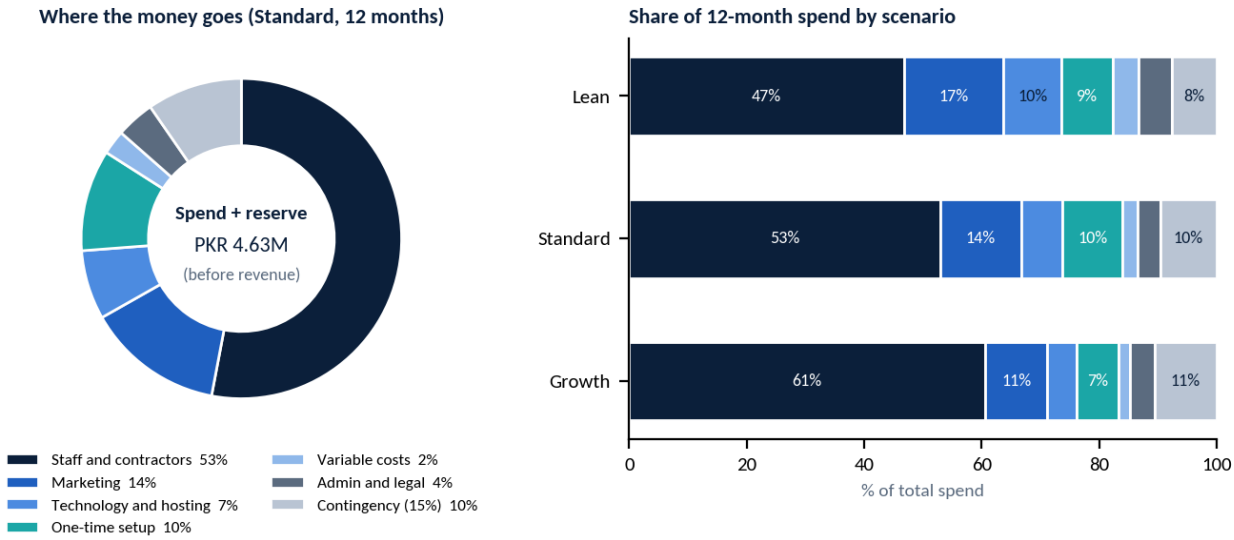


Figure 19. *Investment allocation: where the money goes (Standard) and share by scenario*

10.3 Twelve-month forecast (Standard plan, PKR thousand)

Table 38. *Standard plan 12-month forecast. Cash = funding of PKR 3,450,000 plus cumulative net. Month 1 includes all one-time costs. Forecast, not result*

Month	New cust.	Active cust.	Revenue	Variable	Staff	Market-ing	Tech + admin	One-time	Total cost	Net	Cash
M1	0	0	0	0	15	0	42	475	532	-532	2,918
M2	0	0	0	0	165	0	42	0	207	-207	2,711
M3	0	0	0	0	210	40	42	0	292	-292	2,419
M4	0	0	0	0	265	40	42	0	347	-347	2,072
M5	6	6	15	1	225	80	42	0	348	-332	1,740
M6	10	16	40	2	225	80	42	0	349	-309	1,430
M7	14	29	73	7	225	80	42	0	354	-281	1,150
M8	18	45	115	11	225	80	42	0	358	-243	906

Month	New cust.	Active cust.	Revenue	Variable	Staff	Market-ing	Tech + admin	One-time	Total cost	Net	Cash
M9	21	63	161	15	225	60	42	0	342	-181	725
M10	24	84	213	20	225	60	42	0	347	-135	591
M11	27	106	269	26	225	60	42	0	353	-84	507
M12	30	129	329	31	225	60	42	0	358	-29	478

Reading the table. By month 12 monthly revenue is about PKR 329,194 against operating costs of about PKR 358,476, so the business is still making a monthly operating loss of about PKR 29,282. Closing cash of PKR 477,537 covers roughly 16 months at that loss, enough time for the forecast to reach break-even, but only if customer growth and churn follow the assumptions. Lean and Growth tables are in Appendix A.

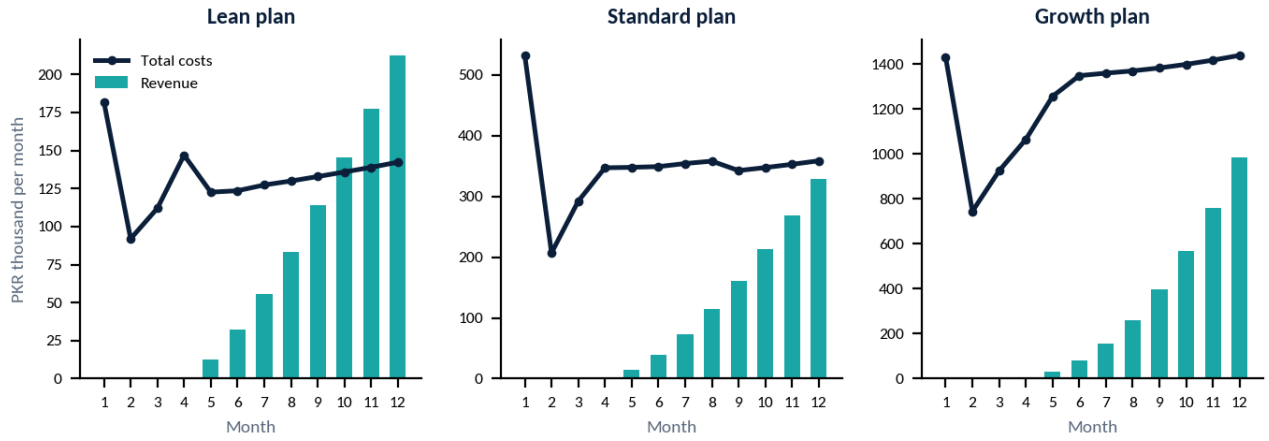


Figure 20. *Monthly revenue versus total costs by scenario (month 1 includes one-time costs)*

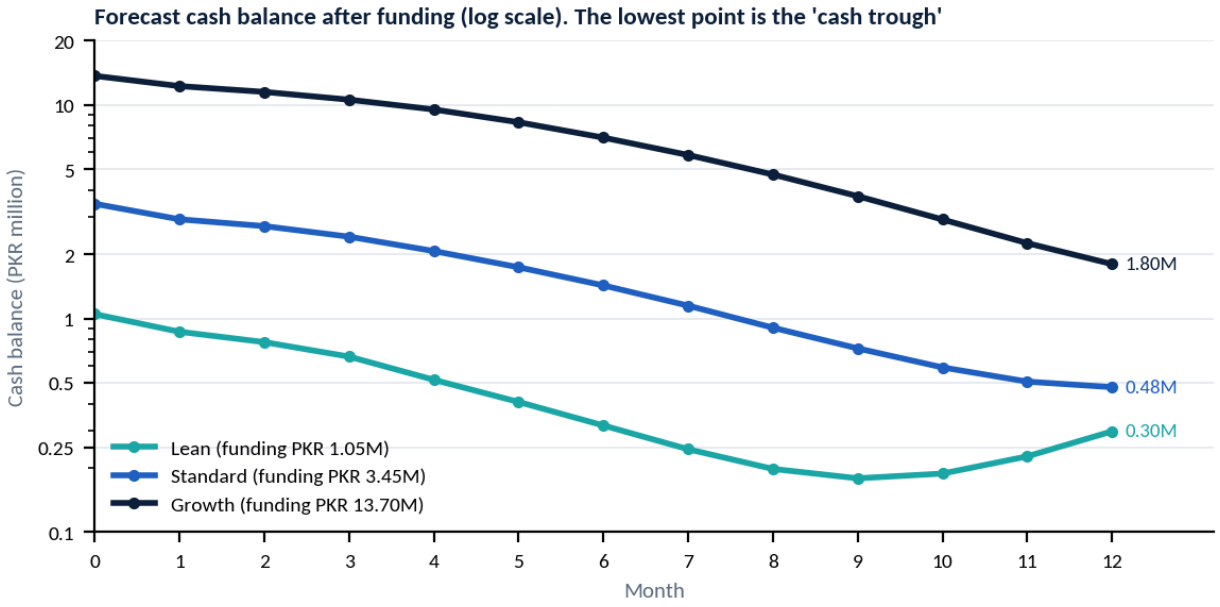


Figure 21. *Cash runway: forecast cash balance after funding by scenario*

10.4 Break-even analysis

Break-even customers = monthly fixed costs / gross profit per customer. Gross profit per customer is PKR 2,305 (ARPU 2,549 minus variable cost 244) [C].

Table 39. *Break-even customer counts (PKR; costs held at month-12 level; extra hires would delay break-even)*

Scenario	Monthly fixed costs (month 12)	Gross profit per customer	Break-even customers	Forecast customers at month 12	Operating break-even (forecast)
Lean	122,000	2,305	53	83	Month 10
Standard	327,000	2,305	142	129	About month 13 if growth continues [A]
Growth	1,345,000	2,305	584	386	About month 15 if growth continues [A]

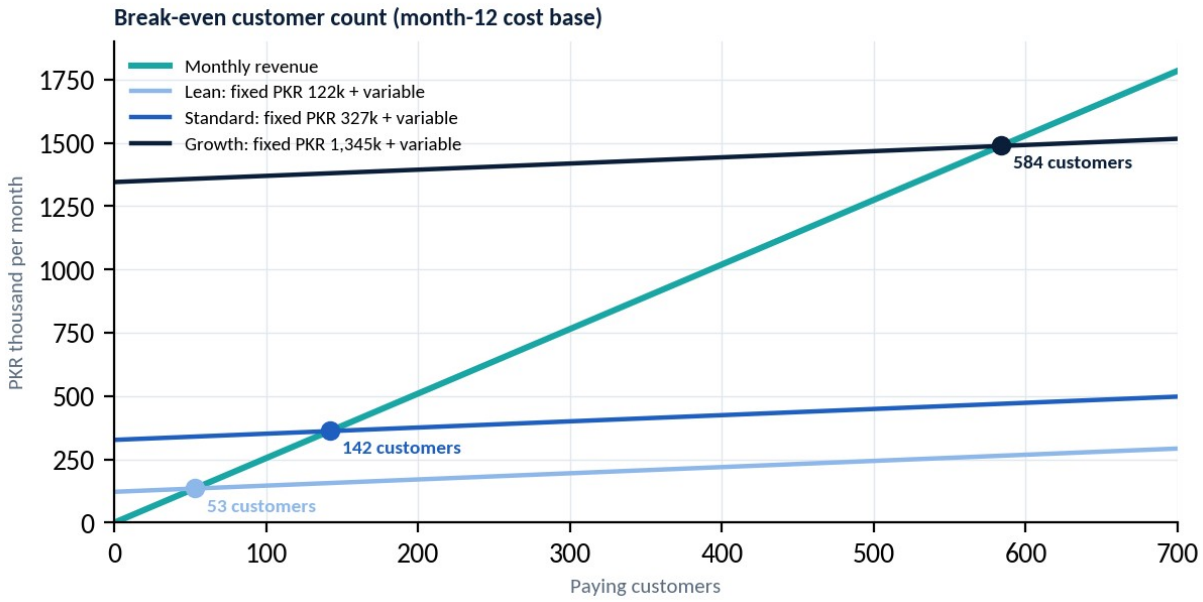


Figure 22. *Break-even analysis: monthly revenue versus cost at different customer counts*

Break-even is operating break-even only. It does not recover the money already invested, pay founders, or cover taxes.

10.5 Twenty-four-month summary (Standard plan, illustrative)

Year-2 assumptions [A]: new customers rise from 32 a month by 2.5 each month, churn falls to 5%, and fixed costs grow 1% a month with extra hires at months 13 (developer, PKR 110,000), 16 (support, 55,000), 19 (marketing, 60,000), and 22 (sales, 60,000). These are weaker assumptions than year 1, so treat them as direction only.

Table 40. *Standard plan, selected months of year 2 (PKR). Illustrative*

Month	Customers	Revenue	Total cost	Net	Cash balance
M14	181	462,421	488,888	-26,466	367,300
M18	300	763,511	591,837	171,673	718,523
M21	398	1,015,152	692,826	322,326	1,471,519
M24	504	1,285,436	797,927	487,508	2,706,123

10.6 Funding sources to consider

- Founders' own savings (Lean plan), friends and family, or small angel investors for the Standard plan.
- Startup competitions, incubators, and university programmes. Specific programmes and terms were not researched here; they must be checked before any application.
- No investor commitment, grant, or loan exists. None is assumed.

Step 11: KPIs and Performance Dashboard

These are proposed management targets, not existing results. Targets are initial settings and should be revised after the pilot.

Table 41. *KPI framework (proposed management targets)*

KPI	Definition and formula	Data source	How often	Owner	Initial target	If missed
Customer interviews completed	Count of completed seller interviews.	Interview log	Weekly	CEO	30 by day 30	Extend 1 week; use referrals; widen segments.
Pilot users onboarded	Count of accounts with first login.	Product database	Weekly	Marketing	10 by day 90	Call the waitlist; offer longer free use.
Active users	Users with 1+ order recorded in last 7 days / total users.	Product log	Weekly	PM	60% of pilot users	Call inactive users; find blockers.
Signup-to-activation	Users who record 5 orders in 14 days / signups.	Product log	Weekly	Support	50%	Simplify setup; add guided import.
Free-to-paid conversion	Paid accounts / signups (cohort).	Billing records	Monthly	CEO	12% by day 120	Test price, trial length, plan limits.
Monthly recurring revenue	Paying customers x ARPU.	Billing records	Monthly	CEO	PKR 15,000 in month 5	Review funnel; boost best channel.
Customer acquisition cost	(Marketing + sales cost) / new paying customers.	Ledger; CRM	Monthly	Marketing	At or below PKR 7,417	Cut weak channels; improve demo-to-signup.
Churn rate	Customers lost / customers at start of month.	Billing records	Monthly	Support	6% or less (alert at 8%)	Call leavers; fix top reason; offer annual plan.
Customer retention	Customers still paying after 3 months / cohort.	Billing records	Monthly	Support	70% or more	Strengthen onboarding and check-ins.
Average revenue per user	MRR / paying customers.	Billing records	Monthly	CEO	Near PKR 2,549	Review plan mix and upgrade prompts.
Support response time	Median time to first reply (working hours).	Ticket log	Weekly	Support	Under 4 hours	Add coverage; use templates.
Product uptime (after launch)	Minutes available / total minutes.	Uptime monitor	Weekly	Developer	99% or more	Root-cause review; improve hosting.
Customer satisfaction (CSAT)	Average rating on a 1-5 survey.	Survey after support and day 30	Monthly	Support	4.0 or more	Read comments; fix top three issues.
Monthly cash burn	Cash out minus cash in for the month.	Ledger; bank	Monthly	Finance	Within plan +10%	Freeze discretionary spending.
Remaining runway	Cash / average monthly burn of last 3 months.	Ledger; bank	Monthly	CEO	6 months or more	Cut costs; raise funds early.

11.1 Provisional targets: 30, 60 and 90 days

Table 42. *Provisional 30/60/90-day targets (proposals; paid revenue starts in month 5)*

KPI	Day 30	Day 60	Day 90
Customer interviews completed	30	30 (complete)	-
Pilot users committed / onboarded	-	10 committed	5-10 onboarded
Prototype / product status	Problem validated; Gate 1 passed	Design frozen; login, dashboard, orders started	Alpha with orders, customers, stock
Active pilot users	-	-	60% active weekly

KPI	Day 30	Day 60	Day 90
Signup-to-activation	-	-	50% of pilot users
Willingness to pay signals	8 of 30 accept price range	-	3 or more pilot users agree to a paid plan
Cash spent vs plan	Within plan	Within plan	Within plan +10%

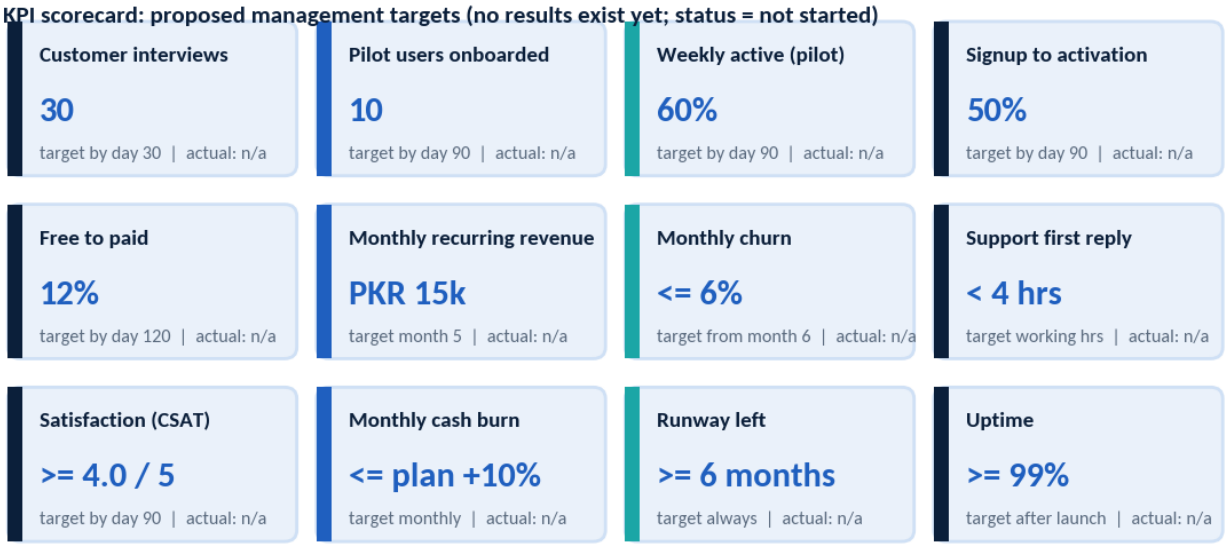


Figure 23. *KPI scorecard (targets only; no actual results exist yet)*

Step 12: Immediate Next Actions

Before spending significant money, do these three things:

1. Align the founders (week 1). Agree written roles, time commitment, equity split, decision rules, and who owns the code. Cost: close to zero.

2. Interview 30 sellers (weeks 1-4). Test the problem, the current tools, and the price range with the questionnaire in Step 2. Cost: a few thousand rupees for transport and thank-you gifts.

3. Show a clickable prototype and collect 10 pilot commitments (weeks 3-6). Use free design tools. Only if Gate 1 is passed, release the next tranche of money.

Table 43. *Implementation checklist for the first eight weeks*

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Duration	Depends on	Deadline	Deliverable	Status
1	Founders' agreement and roles	All founders	Critical	3 days	-	Week 1	Signed agreement	Not started
2	Create interview list and schedule 30 interviews	CEO + marketer	Critical	1 week	1	Week 1	Interview calendar	Not started
3	Run interviews and summarise	CEO + marketer	Critical	4 weeks	2	Week 4	Interview summary	Not started
4	Competitor research and price table	Founder / PM	High	3 weeks	-	Week 3	Competitor sheet	Not started
5	Gate 1 decision meeting	All founders	Critical	1 day	3, 4	Week 4	Go / pivot / stop memo	Not started
6	Clickable prototype and pilot sign-up list	PM + UI designer	High	3 weeks	3	Week 6	Prototype; 10 commitments	Not started
7	Choose legal structure; start registration and NTN; open business account	CEO + accountant	High	3 weeks	5	Week 6	Registration filed	Not started
8	Get quotes: hosting, AI usage, developer, legal drafts	Finance / tech lead	High	2 weeks	5	Week 6	Quotation file; budget v2	Not started
9	Hire or contract developer; set up repository	Tech lead	High	2 weeks	5, 8	Week 6	Developer on board	Not started
10	Start MVP build sprint 1	Developer	High	2 weeks	6, 9	Week 8	Login and dashboard	Not started

Appendix A: Financial Assumptions and Detailed Tables

A.1 Staffing schedules used in the model (PKR per month)

Lean plan

Cost line	PKR per month	From month	To month
Accountant (outsourced, part-time)	10,000	1	12
Contract developer (MVP support)	60,000	2	4
Freelance marketer (part-time)	25,000	4	12
Support and sales assistant (part-time)	35,000	5	12
Hosting and cloud (VPS, backups)	6,000	1	12
Software tools (workspace, design, repo)	8,000	1	12
Admin, bank charges, compliance filings	8,000	1	12

Marketing (PKR per month): M3: 20,000; M4: 30,000; M5: 30,000; M6: 30,000; M7: 30,000; M8: 30,000; M9: 30,000; M10: 30,000; M11: 30,000; M12: 30,000.

One-time cost (month 1)	PKR
Business registration and NTN (sole proprietor / SMC)	15,000
Legal documents (terms, privacy notice review)	25,000
Brand identity and UI design (freelance)	30,000
Equipment (founders use own laptops)	0
Domain, SSL, initial setup	10,000
Outsourced QA and security check	40,000
Pilot incentives (free months, onboarding gifts)	30,000
Total	**150,000**

Standard plan

Cost line	PKR per month	From month	To month
Accountant (outsourced, part-time)	15,000	1	12
Software developer (full-time)	110,000	2	12
Marketing executive (part-time)	45,000	3	12
Sales and support executive (full-time)	55,000	4	12
Contract UI/UX and QA (project)	40,000	2	4
Hosting and cloud (managed DB, backups)	12,000	1	12
Software tools and subscriptions	15,000	1	12
Admin, bank charges, compliance filings	15,000	1	12

Marketing (PKR per month): M3: 40,000; M4: 40,000; M5: 80,000; M6: 80,000; M7: 80,000; M8: 80,000; M9: 60,000; M10: 60,000; M11: 60,000; M12: 60,000.

One-time cost (month 1)	PKR
Company registration (SMC/Pvt Ltd), NTN, bank account	60,000
Legal documents (terms, privacy, contracts)	60,000

One-time cost (month 1)	PKR
Brand identity and UI design	80,000
Equipment (1 laptop + peripherals)	150,000
Domain, SSL, initial setup	15,000
Outsourced QA and security check	60,000
Pilot incentives (free months, onboarding gifts)	50,000
Total	**475,000**

Growth plan

Cost line	PKR per month	From month	To month
Finance and administration (full-time)	45,000	1	12
Lead developer (full-time)	180,000	2	12
Software developer (full-time)	110,000	2	12
Product manager (full-time)	130,000	2	12
Marketing manager (full-time)	100,000	3	12
Sales and business development x2	120,000	4	12
Customer support x2	90,000	5	12
AI and data specialist (part-time)	90,000	6	12
Founder stipends x2	120,000	2	12
Legal / cybersecurity consultant (retainer)	30,000	1	12
Hosting and cloud (production + staging)	30,000	1	12
Software tools and subscriptions	40,000	1	12
Office/co-working, admin, compliance	60,000	1	12

Marketing (PKR per month): M3: 80,000; M4: 100,000; M5: 200,000; M6: 200,000; M7: 200,000; M8: 200,000; M9: 200,000; M10: 200,000; M11: 200,000; M12: 200,000.

Table 44. *Cost schedules by scenario {A}{Q}*

One-time cost (month 1)	PKR
Company registration (Pvt Ltd), NTN, bank account	100,000
Legal documents and IP advice	150,000
Brand identity, UI/UX design (agency)	250,000
Equipment (3 laptops + peripherals)	450,000
Domain, SSL, initial setup	25,000
Penetration test and security audit	150,000
Pilot incentives and launch event	100,000
Total	**1,225,000**

A.2 Lean and Growth plan monthly forecasts (PKR thousand)

Lean plan

Month	New	Active	Revenue	Total cost	Net	Cash
M1	0	0	0	182	-182	868

Month	New	Active	Revenue	Total cost	Net	Cash
M2	0	0	0	92	-92	776
M3	0	0	0	112	-112	664
M4	0	0	0	147	-147	517
M5	5	5	13	123	-110	407
M6	8	13	32	124	-91	316
M7	10	22	56	127	-71	245
M8	12	33	83	130	-47	198
M9	14	45	114	133	-19	179
M10	15	57	145	136	9	188
M11	16	70	177	139	38	226
M12	18	83	213	142	70	297

Growth plan

Table 45. *Lean and Growth 12-month forecasts*

Month	New	Active	Revenue	Total cost	Net	Cash
M1	0	0	0	1,430	-1,430	12,270
M2	0	0	0	745	-745	11,525
M3	0	0	0	925	-925	10,600
M4	0	0	0	1,065	-1,065	9,535
M5	12	12	31	1,256	-1,226	8,309
M6	20	31	80	1,349	-1,269	7,040
M7	32	61	157	1,360	-1,203	5,837
M8	45	103	262	1,370	-1,108	4,728
M9	60	157	399	1,383	-984	3,744
M10	75	222	566	1,399	-833	2,911
M11	90	299	762	1,418	-656	2,255
M12	105	386	984	1,439	-455	1,800

Appendix B: Mermaid Diagram Code

Paste into any Mermaid-compatible tool (for example the Mermaid live editor) to render and edit the Gantt chart. The dates assume Day 1 = 2027-01-04 as an example only; change the start date to match the real start.

```
gantt
  title SmartBiz AI - 52-week plan (example start date)
  dateFormat YYYY-MM-DD
  axisFormat %b %d
  section Phase 1 Research
  Competitor research :t1, 2027-01-04, 21d
  Customer interviews (30) :t2, 2027-01-04, 28d
  Problem validation (Gate 1) :t3, after t2, 7d
  Requirements :t4, 2027-01-18, 21d
  Price validation :t5, 2027-01-18, 21d
  section Phase 2 Design
  Product specification :t6, 2027-01-25, 14d
  UI design :t7, 2027-01-25, 21d
  Database and architecture :t8, 2027-01-25, 21d
  Budget and registration :t9, 2027-01-18, 28d
  section Phase 3 MVP build
  Project setup :t10, 2027-02-01, 14d
  Login and dashboard :t11, 2027-02-08, 21d
  Order management :t12, 2027-02-22, 21d
  Customer records :t13, 2027-03-01, 21d
  Inventory and alerts :t14, 2027-03-08, 21d
  Expenses and reports :t15, 2027-03-22, 21d
  Testing and fixes :t16, 2027-04-05, 21d
  section Phase 4 Pilot
  Recruit pilot users :t17, 2027-03-15, 21d
  Demo and alpha :t18, 2027-03-29, 21d
  Feedback and fixes :t19, 2027-04-05, 35d
  Willingness to pay :t20, 2027-04-19, 21d
  section Phase 5 Launch
  Subscription setup :t21, 2027-04-12, 28d
  Marketing campaigns :t22, 2027-05-03, 63d
  Onboarding and support :t23, 2027-05-03, 63d
  section Phase 6 Growth
  Retention :t25, 2027-06-07, 210d
  AI assistance :t26, 2027-06-28, 84d
  Pricing optimisation :t27, 2027-07-26, 70d
  Integration evaluation :t28, 2027-09-06, 84d
  Partnerships :t29, 2027-10-11, 84d
```

Appendix C: Glossary

Term	Meaning
API	Application Programming Interface: a way for one program to talk to another.
ARPU	Average revenue per user (customer) per month.
CAC	Customer acquisition cost: cost of winning one paying customer.
Churn	The share of customers who cancel in a period.
COD	Cash on delivery: the customer pays the courier on receipt.
CRM	Customer relationship management: software that records customers and contacts.
FBR / NTN	Federal Board of Revenue / National Tax Number.
Gross margin	Revenue minus direct costs, as a share of revenue.
KPI	Key performance indicator: a measure of progress toward a goal.
LTV	Customer lifetime value: gross profit expected from a customer over their stay.
MoSCoW	Must, Should, Could, Won't: a way to rank features.
MRR	Monthly recurring revenue from subscriptions.
MVP	Minimum viable product: the smallest version that tests the idea with real users.
PECA	Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016.
PKR	Pakistani rupee.
RACI	Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed: a role-assignment matrix.
Runway	How many months cash will last at the current spending.
SECP	Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan.
SMC	Single-member company: a private company with one shareholder.
SMEDA	Small and Medium Enterprises Development Authority.
SOM / SAM / TAM	Serviceable obtainable / serviceable available / total addressable market.
SRB / SST	Sindh Revenue Board / Sindh Sales Tax on services.
SWOT	Strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, threats.
Streamlit	An open-source Python framework for building web apps quickly.
SQLite / PostgreSQL	A simple file-based database / a larger server database.

Appendix D: References and Source Links

All links were accessed in October 2026 unless noted. Secondary sources are marked. Verify figures at the source before relying on them.

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15. ManageKaro pricing. https://managekaro.org/pricing
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